

Substance-Related Disorders Behavioral Health Levels of Care Comparison Chart, Adult

MCG Health
Behavioral Health Care
28th Edition

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Substance-Related Disorders Behavioral Health Levels of Care Comparison Chart, Adult

Inpatient Treatment Alternatives

Substance-Related Disorders, Inpatient Behavioral Health Level of Care, Adult BHG

- Admission to **Inpatient Level of Care for Substance-Related Disorder for Adult** (ASAM Criteria, Fourth Edition, Level 4) is indicated due to **ALL** of the following[A][B][C][D][E](8)(10)(16)(17)(18)(19):
 - Patient risk or severity of substance-related disorder is appropriate to inpatient level of care, as indicated by the presence of **1 or more** of the following[F]:
 - ☐ Withdrawal signs related to alcohol, sedative, or opioid with high-risk indicators, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following[G]:
 - Alcohol or sedative withdrawal signs with high-risk indicators are present, as indicated by **ALL** of the following[H](2)(16)(17)(23)
 - CIWA-Ar Calculator:
 - Signs of withdrawal, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following:
 - Heart rate greater than 100 beats per minute
 - Nausea or vomiting
 - Tremor
 - Increased perspiration
 - Other physical signs of alcohol or sedative withdrawal
 - Elevated risk due to historical or comorbid factor, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following:
 - History of delirium due to alcohol or sedative withdrawal
 - History of repetitive seizures due to alcohol or sedative withdrawal[I]
 - Intrinsic seizure disorder (epilepsy)
 - Pregnancy
 - Other significant medical history (eg, severe cardiac disease) that is assessed to be at risk for destabilization due to withdrawal
 - Severe alcohol or sedative withdrawal that is not manageable/treatable at lower level of care is present, as indicated by **ALL** of the following[H](2)(16)(17)

CIWA-Ar Calculator:

Substance-Related Disorders, Residential Behavioral Health Level of Care, Adult BHG

- Admission to **Residential Level of Care for Substance-Related Disorder for Adult** (ASAM Criteria, Fourth Edition, Level 3) is indicated due to **ALL** of the following[S][T][E][U](18)(19):
 - Patient risk or severity of substance-related disorder is appropriate to proposed level of care, as indicated by the presence of **1 or more** of the following(1)(3)(8)(10)(16)(17)(41):
 - ☐ Substance-related disorder with active symptoms is present and requires residential treatment, as indicated by **ALL** of the following:
 - Signs or symptoms of withdrawal requiring acute management, if present, are manageable/treatable at proposed level of care.[H][J](16)(17)(28)(41)(42)
 - CIWA-Ar Calculator
 - COWS Calculator
 - Potential for relapse that places patient at risk of immediate danger outside of treatment in residential care[V](41)
 - Barrier to change that places patient at risk of immediate danger outside of residential care[W]
 - Highly stressful or minimally supportive environment (eg, environment is dangerous and patient needs 24-hour highly structured care setting to develop coping skills and achieve recovery)[X]
 - ☐ **Moderately severe** psychiatric, behavioral, or other comorbid conditions assessed for and are absent or manageable/treatable at proposed level of care, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following[F]:
 - ☐ Psychiatric symptoms, including **1 or more** of the following(20):
 - Hallucinations (adult), Delusions (adult), or other Positive symptoms (adult)
 - Negative symptoms (adult), including social or emotional withdrawal or lack of self-initiated behavior or movement
 - Mania (adult)
 - Depressive symptoms (adult)
 - Anxiety (adult)
 - Hyperactivity or inattention (adult)
 - Obsessions or compulsions (adult)

Observation Behavioral Health Level of Care BHG

- Admission to **Observation Level of Care** is indicated due to **ALL** of the following[P][Q](10)(54)(55)(56)(57):
 - Care needed requires further evaluation, treatment, or disposition arrangement for behavioral health issues, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following(58)(59)(60)(61):
 - Imminent danger to self for adult or imminent danger to self for child or adolescent
 - Imminent danger to others for adult or imminent danger to others for child or adolescent
 - **Severe** dysfunction in daily living for adult or **Severe** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent
 - Patient is experiencing withdrawal or other drug-induced disorder.[H][J](16)(17)(27)(52)(62)(63)
 - CIWA-Ar Calculator
 - COWS Calculator
 - ☐ Observation care is appropriate for anticipated scope and care needed for patient, as indicated by **ALL** of the following:
 - Care is beyond scope of usual outpatient care episode or symptoms are not adequately controlled despite emergency department care.[QQ]
 - Care needed is appropriate for observation care, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following(54)(58)(64):
 - Diagnostic evaluation is needed and is not feasible in outpatient setting (eg, awaiting psychiatric evaluation which is not available in ambulatory care, or outpatient

Crisis Intervention Behavioral Health Level of Care BHG

- Admission to **Crisis Intervention Level of Care** (LOCUS/CALOCUS-CASII Basic Services) is indicated due to **ALL** of the following[PP][VV](34)(68)(71)(72)(73)(74)(75):
 - Around-the-clock behavioral care or close monitoring and intervention is indicated by **1 or more** of the following(76)(77)(78):
 - Danger to self for adult or Danger to self for child or adolescent
 - Danger to others for adult or Danger to others for child or adolescent
 - **Serious** dysfunction in daily living for adult or **Serious** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent
 - ☐ Patient management/treatment at lower level of care is not feasible (eg, lower level of care is unavailable or is not appropriate for patient condition) until acute intervention or modification (eg, acute medication, identification of needed resources and support, change in living situation) is initiated.[WW]
 - ☐ Situation and expectations are appropriate for crisis intervention services, as indicated by **ALL** of the following(4)(24)(52)(66):
 - Recommended treatment is necessary, appropriate, and not feasible at lower level of care (eg, lower level of care is inappropriate for patient condition or is not available).[XX]
 - Sufficient treatment

- Marked signs of withdrawal, as indicated by 1 or more of the following: - Heart rate greater than 120 beats per minute - Severe vomiting - Grossly visible tremor - Profuse perspiration - Temperature greater than 101 degrees F (38.3 degrees C) - Other marked physical signs of alcohol or sedative withdrawal - Signs of withdrawal that require inpatient treatment, as indicated by 1 or more of the following: - Inadequate response to pharmacotherapy in emergency department or other appropriate lower level of care - Lower level of care not feasible or appropriate (eg, unavailable or inappropriate to patient condition or treatment history) - Severely complicated opioid withdrawal that requires around-the-clock care is present, as indicated by ALL of the following[JJ](16)(17)(27)(28) COWS Calculator: - Vomiting or diarrhea due to opioid withdrawal - These effects have caused marked dehydration or electrolyte abnormality (eg, serum potassium less than 2.5 mEq/L (mmol/L), serum sodium less than 130 mEq/L (mmol/L)), and correction (to near normal) in emergency department or other ambulatory setting is not feasible or is inappropriate (eg, less intensive level of care is unavailable or not suitable to patient condition or treatment history). - Acute toxicity or instability from substance use requiring inpatient care (eg, hallucinations in absence of delirium) for which treatment at lower level of care (eg, emergency department, crisis care, observation care) is not feasible or is inappropriate (eg, less intensive level is unavailable or not suitable to patient condition or treatment history)(29) Severe dysfunction in daily living for adult is present, as indicated by 1 or more of the following(4)(14)(30)(31)(32)(33): - Incapacitation because of grave disability (eg, severe regression with inability to provide for self) - Extreme deterioration in social interactions (eg, threatening behaviors with little or no provocation) - Complete withdrawal from all social interactions - Complete neglect of self-care with associated impairment in physical status - Extreme disruption in vegetative function (eg, life-sustaining functions such as eating) - Complete inability to maintain any appropriate aspect of personal responsibility in any adult roles (eg, occupational, parental)	- Personality disorders/maladaptive personality traits - Other psychiatric symptoms related to underlying psychiatric disorder or underlying comorbid condition having a negative impact on primary psychiatric disorder - Comorbid biomedical or developmental condition[Y][Z] - Comorbid substance use disorder[AA][BB] - Cognitive or memory impairment[CC] - Impaired impulse control, judgment, or insight Emotional or behavioral disturbances impacting symptoms or function, including 1 or more of the following[DD](40)(51)(52): - Externalizing symptoms (eg, angry outbursts, physical or verbal aggression, oppositional defiant traits, agitation, anxiety, or other disruptive behaviors) - Internalizing symptoms (eg, sulking, rumination, anhedonia, dysphoria, apathy) - Evidence of severely diminished ability to assess consequences of own actions (eg, acts of severe property damage) - High levels of family conflict or interpersonal conflict - Escalating relapse behaviors - Other emotional or behavioral disturbance relevant to clinical presentation Serious dysfunction in daily living for adult is present, as indicated by 1 or more of the following(4)(14)(30)(31)(32)(33): - Serious deterioration in quality of interpersonal interactions (eg, impulsive or abusive behaviors) - Significant withdrawal and avoidance of almost all social interaction - Consistent failure to achieve self-care (eg, personal hygiene, appearance) to usual standards - Serious disturbance in vegetative status (eg, weight change, sleep disruption) threatening physical function - Inability to perform close to usual standards in adult obligations (eg, work, parenting) and neglecting these responsibilities frequently or over extended period of time - Other evidence of serious dysfunction Danger to self for adult is present due to 1 or more of the following(4)(10)(34): - Command auditory hallucinations contributing to risk for suicide or serious Harm to self - Patient has persistent Thoughts of suicide or serious Harm to self that cannot be adequately monitored or treated at lower level of care as indicated by 1 or more of the following[K]:	evaluation is inappropriate to patient condition). - Acute treatment and response evaluation is needed (eg, acute medication and observation for exacerbation of chronic psychosis). - Monitoring is needed while awaiting suitability for evaluation (eg, patient cannot be adequately assessed because of acute intoxication or substance-induced effect) or psychosocial management and arrangement for follow-up care. - Biopsychosocial stressors[N] potentially contributing to clinical presentation (eg, comorbidities,[RR][SS] illness history, environment,[TT] social network, ability to cope, and level of engagement[UU]) have been assessed and are absent or manageable at proposed level of care.(4)(9)(10)(11)(12)(13)(15)(18)(40)(52)	outcome (eg, stabilization and identification of resources and support for care outside of crisis intervention services) is expected within short time period (eg, 1 to 3 days). - Patient is willing to participate in treatment (or agrees to participate at direction of parent or guardian) within specified intervention and treatment structure voluntarily (or due to court order). [YY][ZZ] - There is no anticipated need for physical restraint, seclusion, or other involuntary control (eg, patient not actively violent). - There is no need for around-the-clock medical or nursing care. - Patient has sufficient ability to respond as planned to individual and group therapeutic interventions.[AAA] - Biopsychosocial stressors[N] potentially contributing to clinical presentation (eg, comorbidities,[RR][SS] illness history, environment,[TT] social network, ability to cope, and level of engagement[UU]) have been assessed and are absent or manageable at proposed level of care.(4)(9)(10)(11)(12)(13)(15)(18)(40)(52)
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- Other evidence of severe dysfunction
- ☐ Imminent danger to self for adult is present due to **1 or more** of the following(4)(10)(34):
- Imminent risk for recurrence of Suicide attempt or act of serious Harm to self is present, as indicated by **ALL** of the following:
 - There has been a recent Suicide attempt or deliberate act of serious Harm to self.
 - There has not been Sufficient relief of the factors that precipitated attempt or act.
 - Current plan for suicide or serious Harm to self is present.
 - Command auditory hallucinations or paranoid delusions contributing to risk for suicide or serious Harm to self are present.
 - Patient has persistent Thoughts of suicide or serious Harm to self that cannot be adequately monitored or treated at lower level of care, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following[K]:
 - Necessary behavioral health care (such as required provider or lower level of care) not available or insufficient
 - Patient support system inadequate
 - Patient characteristics, such as extremely Impaired impulse control, judgment, or insight; severe Mania (adult), severe unreliability, or extreme agitation with desperation
 - Ruminative flooding; uncontrollable and overwhelming negative thoughts
 - Frantic hopelessness; fatalistic conviction that life will not improve, along with oppressive sense of entrapment and doom
- ☐ Imminent danger to others for adult is present due to **1 or more** of the following(4)(10)(34):
- Imminent risk for recurrence of attempt to seriously Harm another is present, as indicated by **ALL** of the following:
 - There has been a recent attempt to seriously Harm another.
 - There has not been Sufficient relief of factors that precipitated the attempt.
 - Current plan for homicide or serious Harm to another is present.
 - Command auditory hallucinations or paranoid delusions contributing to risk for homicide or serious Harm to another are present.
 - Patient has persistent thoughts of homicide or violent acts that likely could result in serious Harm to another that cannot be adequately monitored or treated at lower level of care, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following[K]:
 - Necessary behavioral health care (such as required provider or lower level of care) not available or insufficient
 - Patient support system inadequate
 - Patient characteristics, such as extremely Impaired impulse control, judgment, or insight; severe Mania (adult), severe unreliability, or extreme agitation with desperation

- Necessary behavioral health care (such as required provider or lower level of care) not available or insufficient
 - Patient support system inadequate
 - Patient characteristics, such as moderately severe to severely Impaired impulse control, judgment, or insight; moderate to moderately severe Mania (adult) or unreliability
 - Indication or report of significant physical or sexual risky behavior with Impaired impulse control, judgment, or insight that significantly endangers self
- ☐ Danger to others for adult is present due to **1 or more** of the following(4)(10)(34):
- Command auditory hallucinations or paranoid delusions contributing to risk for homicide or serious Harm to another
 - Patient has persistent thoughts of homicide or serious Harm to another that cannot be adequately monitored or treated at lower level of care, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following[K]:
 - Necessary behavioral health care (such as required provider or lower level of care) not available or insufficient
 - Patient support system inadequate
 - Patient characteristics, such as moderately severe to severely Impaired impulse control, judgment, or insight; moderate to moderately severe Mania (adult) or unreliability
 - Indication or report of significant physical or sexual aggression with Impaired impulse control, judgment, or insight that significantly endangers another
 - Current homicidal ideation with either clearly expressed intentions or past history of carrying out such behavior
- ☐ Withdrawal management is needed and performance in 24-hour setting (residential care environment) is appropriate, as indicated by **ALL** of the following[EE](23)(41):
- Signs of withdrawal are present or risk of development is imminent.[H][J]
 -  CIWA-Ar Calculator
 -  COWS Calculator
 - Patient is judged not to be at risk of withdrawal beyond scope of residential care (eg, no severe or complicated withdrawal).
 - 24-hour residential care treatment environment is needed, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following:
 - Recovery environment is dangerous and patient lacks skills to remain safe outside of around-the-clock treatment program.[FF]
 - Withdrawal management at lower level of care is not

- o Ruminative flooding; uncontrollable and overwhelming negative thoughts
 - o Indication or report of repeated behavior, including physical or sexual aggression that is clearly injurious to others with history, plan or intent, and extremely Impaired impulse control, judgment, or insight
- feasible or is inappropriate (eg, less intensive level of care is unavailable or is not suitable to patient condition or treatment history).

☐ Treatment services available at proposed level of care are necessary to meet patient needs and **1 or more** of the following[L]:

- Specific condition related to admission diagnosis is present and judged likely to further improve at proposed level of care.
- Specific condition related to admission diagnosis is present and judged likely to deteriorate in absence of treatment at proposed level of care.
- Patient is receiving continuing care (eg, transition of care from less intensive level of care).

☐ Situation and expectations are appropriate for inpatient care for adult, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following(4)(10)(20)(24)(35):

- Patient is unwilling to participate in treatment voluntarily and requires treatment (eg, legal commitment) in an involuntary unit.
- Voluntary treatment at lower level of care is not feasible (eg, very short-term crisis intervention or residential care unavailable or insufficient for patient condition).
- Need for physical restraint, seclusion, or other involuntary treatment intervention is present (eg, actively violent patient for whom treatment in an involuntary unit is deemed necessary in accordance with applicable medical and legal criteria).
- Around-the-clock medical and nursing care to address symptoms and initiate intervention is required; specific need is identified.[M]
- Patient management/treatment at lower level of care is not feasible or is inappropriate (eg, less intensive level of care is unavailable or not suitable for patient condition or treatment history).
- Biopsychosocial stressors[N] potentially contributing to clinical presentation (eg, comorbidities,[O][P] illness history, environment,[Q] social network, ability to cope, and level of engagement[R]) have been assessed and are absent or manageable at proposed level of care.(3)(4)(9)(10)(11)(12)(13)(15)(18)(40)

☐ Treatment services available at proposed level of care are necessary to meet patient needs and **1 or more** of the following[L]:

- Specific condition related to admission diagnosis is present and judged likely to further improve at proposed level of care.
- Specific condition related to admission diagnosis is present and judged likely to deteriorate in absence of treatment at proposed level of care.
- Patient is receiving continuing care (eg, transition of care from more or less intensive level of care).

☐ Situation and expectations are appropriate for residential care for adult, as indicated by **ALL** of the following(4)(10):

- Recommended treatment is necessary, appropriate, and not feasible at lower level of care (eg, less intensive level is unavailable or not suitable for patient condition or history).[GG]
- Very short-term crisis intervention and resource planning for further care at nonresidential level is unavailable or inappropriate.
- Patient is willing to participate in treatment within highly structured setting voluntarily (or attend due to court order).[H][I]
- There is no anticipated need for physical restraint, seclusion, or other involuntary control for safety (eg, patient not actively violent).
- Medical or nursing care services to address primary admission diagnosis are available, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following:
 - No anticipated need for around-the-clock medical or nursing monitoring (ie, comorbid medical, psychiatric, or behavioral conditions are absent or are of minimal severity, and are not expected to interfere with recovery).[JJ]
 - Active (but not around-the-clock) monitoring by patient or staff needed, and medical or nursing care can easily be provided if need arises (ie, comorbid medical, psychiatric, or behavioral conditions have potential to distract from treatment).[KK]
 - Around-the-clock medical or nursing monitoring needed, but intensive treatment and resources of licensed hospital are not anticipated (ie, due to severity of primary admitting diagnosis, or presence of active comorbid medical, psychiatric, or behavioral conditions that are distracting from treatment).[LL]
- Patient has sufficient ability to respond as planned to individual and group therapeutic interventions.[MM]
- Biopsychosocial stressors[NN] potentially contributing to clinical presentation (eg, comorbidities,[O][P] illness history, environment,[Q] social network, ability to cope, and level of engagement[OO]) have been assessed and are absent or manageable at proposed level of care.(4)(9)(10)(11)(12)(13)(15)(18)(40)

Outpatient Treatment Alternatives

Substance-Related Disorders, Partial Hospital Behavioral Health Level of Care, Adult BHG

- Admission to **Partial Hospital Program Level of Care for Substance-Related Disorder for Adult** (ASAM Criteria, Fourth Edition, Levels 2.5 and 2.7) is indicated due to **ALL** of the following[BBB][CCC][DDD][E][EEE](18)(19)(70):
 - Patient risk or severity of substance-related disorder is appropriate to proposed level of care, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following(1)(3)(8)(10)(15)(16)(17)(81)(82):
 - ☐ Substance-related disorder with active symptoms is present and requires partial hospital program treatment, as indicated by **ALL** of the following:
 - Signs or symptoms of withdrawal, if present, are manageable/treatable at proposed level of care.[H][J](2)(16)(17)(23)
 -  CIWA-Ar Calculator
 -  COWS Calculator
 - Risk for patient relapse that places patient at risk of danger outside of partial hospital program[FFF](3)
 - Barrier to change that places patient at risk of danger outside of partial hospital program[GGG]
 - Environment is moderately stressful or provides limited support (eg, recovery environment is not supportive, but with daily (or near daily) structure and support, patient can cope with deficits and stressors in environment).[HHH]
 - ☐ **Moderate** psychiatric, behavioral, or other comorbid conditions assessed for and are absent or manageable/treatable at proposed level of care, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following[F]:
 - ☐ Psychiatric symptoms, including **1 or more** of the following(20):
 - Hallucinations (adult), Delusions (adult), or other Positive symptoms (adult)
 - Negative symptoms (adult), including social or emotional withdrawal or lack of self-initiated behavior or movement
 - Mania (adult)
 - Depressive symptoms (adult)
 - Anxiety (adult)
 - Hyperactivity or inattention (adult)
 - Obsessions or compulsions (adult)
 - Personality disorders/maladaptive personality traits
 - Other psychiatric symptoms related to underlying psychiatric disorder or underlying comorbid condition having a negative impact on primary psychiatric disorder
 - Comorbid biomedical or developmental condition[III][Y]
 - Comorbid substance use disorder[AA][P]
 - Cognitive or memory impairment[CC]
 - Impaired impulse control, judgment, or insight
 - ☐ Emotional or behavioral disturbances impacting symptoms or function, including **1 or more** of the

Substance-Related Disorders, Intensive Outpatient Program Behavioral Health Level of Care, Adult BHG

- Admission to **Intensive Outpatient Program Level of Care for Substance-Related Disorder for Adult** (ASAM Criteria, Fourth Edition, Level 2.1) is indicated due to **ALL** of the following[TTT][UUU][E](18)(19):
 - Patient risk or severity of substance-related disorder is appropriate to proposed level of care, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following(1)(3)(8)(10)(15)(16)(17)(81)(82):
 - ☐ Substance-related disorder with active symptoms is present and requires intensive outpatient treatment, as indicated by **ALL** of the following:
 - Signs or symptoms of withdrawal, if present, are manageable/treatable at proposed level of care.[H][J](2)(16)(17)(23)
 -  CIWA-Ar Calculator
 -  COWS Calculator
 - Risk for patient relapse outside of treatment in intensive outpatient program[VVV](3)
 - Barriers to change that require support available in intensive outpatient program[WWW]
 - Environmental stressors are mild to moderate and manageable in intensive outpatient program (eg, patients are able to apply and develop skills to cope with stressors).[XXX]
 - ☐ **Mild to moderate** psychiatric, behavioral, or other comorbid conditions assessed for and are absent or manageable/treatable at proposed level of care, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following[F]:
 - ☐ Psychiatric symptoms, including **1 or more** of the following(20):
 - Hallucinations (adult), Delusions (adult), or other Positive symptoms (adult)
 - Negative symptoms (adult), including social or emotional withdrawal or lack of self-initiated behavior or movement
 - Mania (adult)
 - Depressive symptoms (adult)
 - Anxiety (adult)
 - Hyperactivity or inattention (adult)
 - Obsessions or compulsions (adult)
 - Personality disorders/maladaptive personality traits
 - Other psychiatric symptoms related to underlying psychiatric disorder or underlying comorbid condition having a negative impact on primary psychiatric disorder
 - Comorbid biomedical or developmental condition[III][Y]
 - Comorbid substance use disorder[AA][P]
 - Cognitive or memory impairment[CC]
 - Impaired impulse control, judgment, or insight
 - ☐ Emotional or behavioral disturbances impacting symptoms or function, including **1 or more** of the

Substance-Related Disorders, Outpatient Behavioral Health Level of Care, Adult BHG

- Admission to **Outpatient Level of Care for Substance-Related Disorder for Adult** (ASAM Criteria, Fourth Edition, Levels 1.5 and 1.7) is indicated due to **ALL** of the following[ZZZ][AAA][BBB][E](18)(19):
 - Patient risk or severity of substance-related disorder is appropriate to proposed level of care, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following(1)(3)(4)(8)(10)(16)(17)(24)(81):
 - ☐ Substance-related disorder with active symptoms is present and requires outpatient treatment, as indicated by **ALL** of the following:
 - Signs or symptoms of withdrawal are mild or absent and manageable/treatable at proposed level of care.[H][J](2)(16)(17)(23)
 -  CIWA-Ar Calculator
 -  COWS Calculator
 - Risk for relapse is low and can be supported in outpatient care (ie, structured treatment program is not required).[CCCC](3)
 - Barriers to change are mild and can be supported in outpatient care.[DDDD]
 - Environmental stressors are mild and manageable with support available in outpatient care.[EEEE]
 - ☐ **Mild** psychiatric, behavioral, or other comorbid conditions assessed for and are absent or manageable/treatable at proposed level of care, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following[F]:
 - ☐ Psychiatric symptoms, including **1 or more** of the following(20):
 - Hallucinations (adult), Delusions (adult), or other Positive symptoms (adult)
 - Negative symptoms (adult), including social or emotional withdrawal or lack of self-initiated behavior or movement
 - Mania (adult)
 - Depressive symptoms (adult)
 - Anxiety (adult)
 - Hyperactivity or inattention (adult)
 - Obsessions or compulsions (adult)
 - Personality disorders/maladaptive personality traits
 - Other psychiatric symptoms related to underlying psychiatric disorder or underlying comorbid condition having a negative impact on primary psychiatric disorder
 - Comorbid biomedical or developmental condition[III][Y]
 - Comorbid substance use disorder[AA][P]
 - Cognitive or memory impairment[CC]
 - Impaired impulse control, judgment, or insight
 - ☐ Emotional or behavioral disturbances impacting symptoms or function, including **1 or more** of the following[DD](40)(51)(52):
 - Externalizing symptoms (eg, angry outbursts, physical or

Day Treatment Behavioral Health Level of Care BHC

- Admission to **Day Treatment Level of Care** is indicated due to **ALL** of the following[HHH][III][PP]:
 - Behavioral health disorder is present patient symptom severity and function status is appropriate proposed level of care as indicated by **ALL** the following[JJJ][P](4)(10)(15)(52)(66):
 - Mild to moderate** psychiatric, behavioral, or other comorbid conditions for adult or **Mild to moderate** psychiatric, behavioral, or other comorbid conditions for child or adolescent [L][MMMM][NNNN]
 - Mild to moderate** psychiatric dysfunction in daily living for adult or **Mild to moderate** psychiatric dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent
 - ☐ Patient condition does not require urgent intervention, as indicated by **ALL** of the following[OOO]:
 - Signs or symptoms related to admitting diagnosis (or impact of comorbidity or admitting diagnosis) are stable or improving and there has not been an acute increase in condition severity
 - Impairments in function are stable or improving and there has not been a recent substantial deterioration in function.
 - ☐ Treatment services available at proposed level of care are necessary meet patient needs and **or more** of the following[PPPP]:
 - Specific condition related to admission diagnosis is present and judged likely to further improve proposed level of care.
 - Specific condition related to admission diagnosis is present and judged likely to deteriorate in absence of treatment at

following(DD)(40)(51)(52): - Externalizing symptoms (eg, angry outbursts, physical or verbal aggression, oppositional defiant traits, agitation, anxiety, or other disruptive behaviors) - Internalizing symptoms (eg, sulking, rumination, anhedonia, dysphoria, apathy) - Evidence of severely diminished ability to assess consequences of own actions (eg, acts of severe property damage) - High levels of family conflict or interpersonal conflict - Escalating relapse behaviors - Other emotional or behavioral disturbance relevant to clinical presentation ☐ Moderate dysfunction in daily living for adult is present, as indicated by 1 or more of the following(4)(14)(30)(31)(32)(33): - Recent conflicted, withdrawn, or troubled relationships, but maintains control of impulsive, aggressive, or abusive behaviors - Self-care frequently below usual or expected standards - Significant disturbance in vegetative status (eg, eating, sleeping habits), but not posing serious threat to health - Significant deterioration in ability to fulfill responsibilities (eg, work, commitments to significant others), including neglect or avoidance of these responsibilities on some occasions - Ongoing and variably severe deficits in interpersonal relationships and ability to engage socially in constructive manner - Other evidence of moderate dysfunction ☐ Danger to self for adult is present due to 1 or more of the following(4)(10)(34): - Command auditory hallucinations contributing to risk for suicide or serious Harm to self - Patient has persistent Thoughts of suicide or serious Harm to self that cannot be adequately monitored or treated at lower level of care as indicated by 1 or more of the following(I)(K): - Necessary behavioral health care (such as required provider or lower level of care) not available or insufficient - Patient support system inadequate - Patient characteristics, such as moderately severe to severely Impaired impulse control, judgment, or insight; moderate to moderately severe Mania (adult) or unreliability	following(DD)(40)(51)(52): - Externalizing symptoms (eg, angry outbursts, physical or verbal aggression, oppositional defiant traits, agitation, anxiety, or other disruptive behaviors) - Internalizing symptoms (eg, sulking, rumination, anhedonia, dysphoria, apathy) - Evidence of severely diminished ability to assess consequences of own actions (eg, acts of severe property damage) - High levels of family conflict or interpersonal conflict - Escalating relapse behaviors - Other emotional or behavioral disturbance relevant to clinical presentation ☐ Mild to moderate dysfunction in daily living for adult is present, as indicated by 1 or more of the following(4)(14)(30)(31)(32)(33): - Some recent deterioration in interpersonal interactions (eg, conflicted, withdrawn), but maintains control of impulsive or abusive behaviors and maintains some meaningful relationships - Some recent disruptions in self-care below usual or expected standards - Disturbance in vegetative status (eg, eating, sleeping habits) that does not pose serious threat to health - Some deterioration in social role functioning and meeting obligations (eg, avoiding responsibilities on some occasions), but still can maintain roles overall - Other evidence of mild to moderate dysfunction ☐ Danger to self for adult is present but low, as indicated by ALL of the following(4)(10): - Absent or minimal Thoughts of suicide or serious Harm to self - Absent or low intent to act on thoughts of Harm - No current plan is present. ☐ Danger to others for adult is present but low, as indicated by ALL of the following(4)(10): - Absent or minimal thoughts of homicide or serious Harm to another - Absent or low intent to act on thoughts of Harm - No current plan is present. ☐ Withdrawal management is needed due to evidence of current or presumed imminent withdrawal in patient judged to be at risk for severe withdrawal without structured intensive outpatient program.(H)(J)(2)(16)(17)(23) CIWA-Ar Calculator COWS Calculator ☐ Treatment services available at proposed level of care are necessary to meet patient needs and 1 or more of the following(L): - Specific condition related to admission diagnosis is present and judged likely to further improve at proposed level of care. - Specific condition related to admission diagnosis is present and	verbal aggression, oppositional defiant traits, agitation, anxiety, or other disruptive behaviors) - Internalizing symptoms (eg, sulking, rumination, anhedonia, dysphoria, apathy) - Evidence of severely diminished ability to assess consequences of own actions (eg, acts of severe property damage) - High levels of family conflict or interpersonal conflict - Escalating relapse behaviors - Other emotional or behavioral disturbance relevant to clinical presentation ☐ Mild dysfunction in daily living for adult is present, as indicated by 1 or more of the following(4)(14)(30)(31)(32)(33): - Some deterioration in interpersonal interactions (eg, increased conflict), but able to maintain some meaningful relationships - Some recent minor disruptions in self-care - Minor but consistent disruptions in social role functioning and meeting obligations, but still able to maintain these roles - Self-neglect with at least some minor limitation in ability to provide for basic needs (by self or others) in maintenance care - Other evidence of mild dysfunction - Withdrawal management is needed for evidence of current or presumed likely withdrawal in patient judged to be at low risk for severe or complicated withdrawal.(H)(J)(2)(16)(17)(23)(28) CIWA-Ar Calculator COWS Calculator ☐ Treatment services available at proposed level of care are necessary to meet patient needs and 1 or more of the following(L): - Specific condition related to admission diagnosis is present and judged likely to further improve at proposed level of care. - Specific condition related to admission diagnosis is present and judged likely to deteriorate in absence of treatment at proposed level of care. - Patient is receiving continuing care (eg, transition of care from more or less intensive level of care). ☐ Situation and expectations are appropriate for outpatient care for adult, as indicated by ALL of the following(FFFF)(10)(20): - Recommended treatment is necessary and appropriate, given patient condition or history.(GGGG) - Patient is willing to participate in treatment voluntarily.(HH)(II) - Patient has sufficient ability to respond as planned to individual and group therapeutic interventions.(RRR) - Biopsychosocial stressors(N) potentially contributing to clinical presentation (eg, comorbidities.(O)(P) illness history, environment,(Q) social network, ability to cope, and level of engagement(R)) have been assessed and are absent or manageable at proposed level of care.(3)(4)(9)(10)(11)(12)(13)(15)(18)(40)	proposed level of care. - Patient is receiving continuing care (eg, transition of care from more or less intensive level of care). ☐ Situation and expectations are appropriate for day treatment services, as indicated by ALL of the following(4)(40)(52)(66): - Recommended treatment is necessary and appropriate(Q and not feasible with less intensive intervention (less intensive support, such as outpatient care not suitable to patient condition or history)).(XX) - Patient and family or caregivers appropriate, and willing to participate in treatment voluntarily.(YY) - Patient has sufficient ability to respond as planned to individual and group therapeutic interventions.(100)(101) - Biopsychosocial stressors(N) potentially contributing to clinical presentation (eg, comorbidities (SS) illness history, environment,(L) social network, ability to cope, and level of engagement(M) have been assessed and are absent or manageable at proposed level of care.(4)(9)(10)(11)(12)(13)(15)(18)(40)(52)
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- o Indication or report of significant physical or sexual risky behavior with Impaired impulse control, judgment, or insight that significantly endangers self

☐ Danger to others for adult is present due to **1 or more** of the following(4)(10)(34):

- Command auditory hallucinations or paranoid delusions contributing to risk for homicide or serious Harm to another
- Patient has persistent thoughts of homicide or serious Harm to another that cannot be adequately monitored or treated at lower level of care, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following^[K]:
 - o Necessary behavioral health care (such as required provider or lower level of care) not available or insufficient
 - o Patient support system inadequate
 - o Patient characteristics, such as moderately severe to severely Impaired impulse control, judgment, or insight; moderate to moderately severe Mania (adult) or unreliability
 - o Indication or report of significant physical or sexual aggression with Impaired impulse control, judgment, or insight that significantly endangers another
 - o Current homicidal ideation with either clearly expressed intentions or past history of carrying out such behavior

- Withdrawal management is needed due to evidence of current or presumed imminent withdrawal in patient judged to be at risk for severe withdrawal without structured partial hospital program.^{[H][J](2)(16)(17)(23)}

(28)  CIWA-Ar Calculator

 COWS Calculator

☐ Treatment services available at proposed level of care are necessary to meet patient needs and **1 or more** of the following^[L]:

- Specific condition related to admission diagnosis is present and judged likely to further improve at proposed level of care.
- Specific condition related to admission diagnosis is present and judged likely to deteriorate in absence of treatment at proposed level of care.
- Patient is receiving continuing care (eg, transition of care from more or less intensive level of care).

☐ Situation and expectations are appropriate for partial hospital program for adult, as indicated by **ALL** of the following^{[JJ][KK][LLL]}(4)(10)(20)(70):

- Recommended treatment is necessary, appropriate, and not feasible at lower level of care (eg, less intensive level is unavailable or not suitable to patient condition or history).^[MMM]
- Patient is willing to participate in treatment voluntarily.^{[NNN][OOO][PPP]}
- There is no anticipated need for physical restraint or other involuntary treatment interventions.
- There is no need for around-the-clock medical or nursing care.

judged likely to deteriorate in absence of treatment at proposed level of care.

- Patient is receiving continuing care (eg, transition of care from more or less intensive level of care).

☐ Situation and expectations are appropriate for intensive outpatient program for adult, as indicated by **ALL** of the following^{[KKK][LLL][YYY]}(10)(20):

- Recommended treatment is necessary, appropriate, and not feasible at lower level of care (eg, less intensive level is unavailable or not suitable to patient condition or history).^[MMM]
- Patient is willing to participate in treatment voluntarily.^{[NNN][OOO][PPP]}
- Patient has sufficient ability to respond as planned to individual and group therapeutic interventions.^{[RRR][SSS]}
- Biopsychosocial stressors^[N] potentially contributing to clinical presentation (eg, comorbidities,^{[O][P]} illness history, environment,^[Q] social network, ability to cope, and level of engagement^[R]) have been assessed and are absent or manageable at proposed level of care.⁽³⁾⁽⁴⁾⁽⁹⁾⁽¹⁰⁾⁽¹¹⁾⁽¹²⁾⁽¹³⁾⁽¹⁵⁾⁽¹⁸⁾⁽⁴⁰⁾

- There has been no recent attempt or Current plan to seriously Harm another.
- There has been no recent Suicide attempt or act of serious Harm to self, or there has been Sufficient relief of precipitants of any such action.
- There is no Current plan for suicide or serious Harm.
- Patient's family, caregiver, or other available resources can adequately monitor patient condition when away from partial hospital program (ie, partial hospital program resources are sufficient to address any inadequacies in support system). [QQQ]
- Patient will contact care provider or support if Current plan for suicide or serious Harm develops.[PPP]
- Patient has sufficient ability to respond as planned to individual and group therapeutic interventions.[RRR] [SSS]
- Biopsychosocial stressors[N] potentially contributing to clinical presentation (eg, comorbidities,[O][P] illness history, environment,[Q] social network, ability to cope, and level of engagement[R]) have been assessed and are absent or manageable at proposed level of care.(3)(4)(9)(10)(11)(12)(13)(15)(18)(40)

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Footnotes

[A] Inpatient programs for the treatment of substance-related disorders in adults provide 24-hour care to stabilize patients with multidimensional imminent danger due to severe, unstable withdrawal symptoms; biomedical conditions requiring around-the-clock treatment; or emotional, cognitive, or behavioral concerns that require around-the-clock nursing or medical monitoring. A covering physician is available to assess patients if indicated around the clock.(1)(2)(3)(4) [A in Context Link 1]

[B] The American Society of Addiction Medicine (ASAM) describes this level of service intensity as Medically Managed Inpatient Treatment, Level 4 (ASAM Criteria, Fourth Edition).(2)(3) The corresponding Level of Care for Alcohol and Drug Treatment Referral 3.0 (LOCADTR 3.0) is Medically Managed Inpatient Detoxification.(5) [B in Context Link 1]

[C] Specialty centers providing inpatient treatment for substance use disorders often do so in a freestanding inpatient facility with medical monitoring available. Withdrawal management may be provided in a freestanding withdrawal management center or by intensive medical management in an inpatient psychiatric or medical unit depending on need, but it works best when coupled with chronic disease management for the underlying substance use disorder.(2) [C in Context Link 1]

[D] For patients undergoing alcohol withdrawal, ICU admission is indicated for delirium tremens, hemodynamic instability, arrhythmias, uncontrolled seizures, need for anesthetic agent to control agitation, or respiratory depression with need for, or high likelihood of requiring, mechanical ventilation.(6)(7)(8) [D in Context Link 1]

[E] The purpose of the care guidelines is to promote evidence-based care across the continuum of care to enhance the delivery of quality healthcare. Indications are presented for different levels of care. These indications help define the optimal level of care and can assist in developing alternatives to higher levels of care, tracking patient progress during treatment within a level of care, facilitating the progress of patients whose recovery is delayed, and preparing comprehensive plans for transition of patients from one level of care to another. Relevant professional society guidelines are foundational content for evaluation and treatment of behavioral health disorders at different levels of care and are complemented by the best available published evidence.(3)(4)(9)(10)(11)(12)(13)(14)(15) [E in Context Link 1, 2, 3, 4, 5]

[F] Determination of severity may be based on symptom severity alone (including intensity or frequency of symptoms and the extent to which they interfere with functioning), or may be due to other factors (eg, comorbid medical illness, developmental condition, cognitive impairment, substance use disorder, or other factors that contribute to destabilization or decreased ability to cope with the underlying behavioral health disorder). If the comorbidity affects the level of care appropriate to meet the patient's behavioral health needs, the manner in which it impacts the behavioral health condition (and how the comorbidity will be managed/treated at the proposed level of care) should be documented in order to optimize comprehensive patient care. Assessment for comorbid conditions should take place at admission evaluation, and any identified conditions should be manageable/treatable by the program (either directly or through alternative arrangements). Co-occurring mental health and substance use conditions and co-occurring medical and behavioral health conditions are considered an expectation, not an exception, in all programs at all psychiatric and addiction service levels of care. Integrated care, with recovery-oriented and "co-occurring capable" services, is increasingly expected to be included in the design of programs at all levels of care and in all settings. In programs without integrated care, comorbidities that require more active management/treatment or that currently distract the patient from treatment or have been associated with challenges in treatment follow-through in the past should prompt consideration of a program designed to provide treatment for both disorders (eg, a dual-diagnosis program).(1)(3)(4)(9)(10)(11)(12)(20) [F in Context Link 1, 2, 3, 4, 5]

[G] "Sedative" refers collectively to sedatives, hypnotics, and anxiolytics. [G in Context Link 1]

[H] The Clinical Institute Withdrawal Assessment tool (CIWA) is used to assess 10 common withdrawal signs and symptoms, including: nausea/vomiting, tremor, anxiety, agitation, paroxysmal sweats; orientation and clouding of sensorium; tactile, auditory, and visual disturbances; and headache. The cumulative score is used to guide treatment management for patients undergoing withdrawal, and ranges from 0 to 67. Withdrawal severity may be categorized by score: mild (less than 10), moderate (10 to 18), severe (19 or greater with the absence of seizure, delirium, or hallucinations), or complicated (19 or greater with the presence of seizure, delirium, or new-onset hallucinations).(8)(21)(22) [H in Context Link 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11]

[I] Alcohol withdrawal seizures typically occur within 48 hours of termination of a prolonged period of heavy alcohol use, although they occasionally occur after brief alcohol binges (measured in days). Seizures due to withdrawal from sedatives or anxiolytics with half-lives much longer than that of alcohol can occur many days after terminating the use of the substance.(24) [I in Context Link 1]

[J] The Clinical Opiate Withdrawal Scale (COWS) is used by clinicians to measure 11 commonly observed opiate withdrawal signs or symptoms, including: resting pulse, sweating, restlessness, pupil size, bone or joint aches, runny nose or tearing, gastrointestinal upset, tremor, yawning, anxiety or irritability, and gooseflesh skin. Cumulative scores are described as mild (5 to 12), moderate (13 to 24), moderately severe (25 to 36), and severe (greater than 36). The COWS was developed to guide buprenorphine induction, and can be used to track opiate withdrawal symptoms over time or in response to treatment.(25)(26) [J in Context Link 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10]

[K] Patients with persistent thoughts of suicide, homicide, or serious harm to self or another may need frequent monitoring for progression to planning or intention to act on their thoughts. Such monitoring can be safely conducted at an outpatient level of care if providers and supports are adequately available and the patient can reliably participate in the monitoring process.(10) [K in Context Link 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6]

[L] Assessment of the likelihood of benefit at the proposed level of care may help identify subgroups of patients who may be more likely to respond to particular treatments and help optimize the care plan to increase the likelihood of successful recovery. It may also help determine if a specialized treatment setting (eg, dual-diagnosis program) or a different level of service intensity would be more appropriate to address the patient's needs.(3)(4) [L in Context Link 1, 2, 3, 4, 5]

[M] Examples of medical conditions appropriate for inpatient care include conditions that require intensive, around-the-clock medical monitoring and daily nursing interventions, or patients with significant metabolic or ECG abnormalities related to vomiting.(4) [M in Context Link 1]

[N] Biopsychosocial stressors may impact the level of care necessary to manage a psychiatric or behavioral condition, including the ability of the program to meet comprehensive patient needs, ensure treatment adherence, enhance motivation, or prevent relapse (ie, comorbidities, environmental factors, or other barriers may prevent effective treatment at a less intensive level of care than might otherwise be appropriate to the patient's condition). Biopsychosocial assessment factors should be incorporated into care planning, including planned treatment goals, and intensity and duration of interventions. A "whole person care" approach that coordinates care across physical health, behavioral health, and social service sectors may bridge the gap of physical and mental health.(36)(37)(38)(39) Any identified deficits should be manageable by the program directly or through alternative arrangements.(4)(9)(11)(12) [N in Context Link 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7]

[O] Comorbid conditions may directly impact the experience of psychiatric symptoms (eg, COPD and anxiety), or may indirectly impact determination of the appropriate venue for care (eg, routine blood sugar and insulin management in people with diabetes). If clinically appropriate, testing related to diagnosis or management (eg, screening for liver and kidney function, hepatitis, HIV, syphilis, tuberculosis) may be performed off-site.(4)(9)(11)(12) Assessment and treatment of co-occurring medical and/or developmental conditions through services and treatment settings capable of rendering integrated care is recommended.(4)(9)(10)(11)(12)(13) A "whole person care" approach that coordinates care across physical health, behavioral health, and social service sectors may bridge the gap of physical and mental health.(36)(37)(38)(39) The level that comorbid medical and/or developmental conditions are present may be described on a continuum (none/absent, low, moderate, and severe) and may impact determination of the appropriate level of care for treatment (ie, admission to a higher level of care).(3)(4)(9)(11)(12) [O in Context Link 1, 2, 3, 4, 5]

[P] Evaluation/assessment and treatment of co-occurring substance use disorders through services and treatment settings capable of rendering integrated care is recommended.(4)(9)(10)(11)(12) A "whole person care" approach that coordinates care across physical health, behavioral health, and social service sectors may bridge the gap of physical and mental health.(36)(37)(38)(39) The level that comorbid substance use disorders contribute to the primary presenting condition may be described on a continuum (none/absent, low, moderate, and severe) and may impact determination of the appropriate level of care for treatment (ie, admission to a higher level of care or specialty dual-diagnosis program).(3)(4)(9)(11)(12) [P in Context Link 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8]

[Q] The degree of environmental stressors and amount of support in the patient recovery environment should be considered in the context of the clinical presentation in determining the appropriate level of care for treatment. The level of environmental stressors may be low, mild, moderate, high, or extreme. The level of support in the environment may range from absent or minimal to limited to supportive or highly supportive.(3)(4)(9)(10)(11)(12)(13) [Q in Context Link 1, 2, 3, 4, 5]

[R] Participation motivated by a wish to avoid negative consequences rather than accept the need to work toward recovery may require more intense monitoring and follow-up.(1)(3) The patient's level of engagement may be described on a continuum: optimal, positive, limited, minimal, or unengaged. Readiness to change may range from actively and willingly engaged to unable to follow treatment recommendations due to clinical condition.(3)(4)(9)(11)(12) [R in Context Link 1, 2, 3, 4]

[S] Residential care programs for the treatment of substance-related disorders in adults provide 24-hour care with trained counselors to stabilize multidimensional danger. Danger in the context of substance use disorder treatment includes the strong probability of continued substance use or relapse, the likelihood of adverse consequences related to use (eg, driving while intoxicated), and the likelihood that the adverse events will occur in the near future, that is in hours to days rather than in weeks to months.(1)(3)(4)(41) Multidimensional factors may include withdrawal symptoms; biomedical complications; or emotional, cognitive, or behavioral concerns.(3) Residential care is intended for patients who need around-the-clock behavioral care but do not need the high level of physical security and frequency of psychiatric and medical intervention available on an inpatient unit. Specialty centers providing residential treatment for substance-related disorders may do so in therapeutic rehabilitation facilities, therapeutic communities, or residential treatment centers; and withdrawal management may be provided in a variety of 24-hour social setting environments.(41) [S in Context Link 1]

[T] The American Society of Addiction Medicine (ASAM) defines 3 sublevels (Levels 3.1, 3.5, and 3.7) within Level 3 (ASAM Criteria, Fourth Edition) for adults, which range from least intensive residential services to medically managed residential services.(41) [T in Context Link 1]

[U] Examples of medical conditions appropriate for residential care include conditions that require active monitoring (either by patient or staff) and have the potential to distract from treatment of the admitting diagnosis, but are not so severe that they require the intensive level of monitoring provided in inpatient treatment.(4) [U in Context Link 1]

[V] Residential care is appropriate to manage patients at increased risk of relapse due to inability to control use (patient lacks necessary skills), and continued use places patient or others at risk of danger.(4)(41) [V in Context Link 1]

[W] Patients appropriate for residential care require highly structured, around-the-clock treatment due to limited awareness of their problem with substance use, or opposition to or lack of interest in treatment. Participation motivated by a wish to avoid negative consequences rather than acceptance of the need to work toward recovery may require more intense monitoring and follow-up.(1)(4)(41) [W in Context Link 1]

[X] Examples of highly stressful environments include serious disruption of the family unit (eg, death, divorce), threat of severe disruption in life circumstances (eg, imminent incarceration or deportation), inability to meet material needs, difficulty avoiding active substance use (or pressure to participate in substance use), or exposure to dangerous or criminal activities in the family or neighborhood. Examples of minimal environmental support include few actual or potential sources of support, or unwillingness or inability of usual supports to provide help.(3)(4) [X in Context Link 1]

[Y] A significant comorbid biomedical or developmental condition has the potential to prolong the course of illness, or necessitate admission to a higher level of care or closer monitoring of patients requiring psychiatric care.(4)(9)(11)(12)(43) [Y in Context Link 1, 2, 3, 4]

[Z] Assessment and treatment of co-occurring medical and/or developmental conditions through services and treatment settings capable of rendering integrated care is recommended.(4)(9)(10)(11)(12)(13) The level that comorbid medical and/or developmental conditions are present may be described on a continuum (none/absent, low, moderate, and severe) and may impact determination of the appropriate level of care for treatment (ie, admission to a higher level of care).(3)(4)(9)(11)(12) [Z in Context Link 1]

[AA] A significant comorbid substance use disorder (either reflecting comorbidity in a patient whose primary diagnosis is a psychiatric disorder, such as an affective disorder, or is present in a patient with a polysubstance use disorder) has the potential to impact the appropriate level of care in which the underlying condition is managed/treated, or require consideration of a program with structures in place to treat multiple conditions, such as a dual-diagnosis program. The risk for problems with substance use is increased with the presence of many types of behavioral disturbance (eg, impulse control disorders, or self-medication of depression or anxiety symptoms). The severity of the substance use disorder as it relates to the underlying psychiatric condition includes the frequency and chronicity of use, ability to control use, intensity of other symptoms (eg, cravings, withdrawal), or other negative impact on the underlying condition.(1)(3)(4)(9)(11)(12) [AA in Context Link 1, 2, 3, 4]

[BB] Evaluation/assessment and treatment of co-occurring substance use disorders through services and treatment settings capable of rendering integrated care is recommended.(4)(9)(10)(11)(12) The level that comorbid substance use disorders contribute to the primary presenting condition may be described on a continuum (none/absent, low, moderate, and severe) and may impact determination of the appropriate level of care for treatment (ie, admission to a higher level of care or specialty dual-diagnosis program).(3)(4)(9)(11)(12) [BB in Context Link 1]

[CC] Intake and assessment should include a mental status examination and memory assessment. If cognitive impairments are identified, they may require modifying the intensity or pace of planned interventions to allow the patient to participate in the program, or using an enhanced program designed to address co-occurring cognitive disorders.(1)(44)(45)(46)(47)(48) [CC in Context Link 1, 2, 3, 4]

[DD] Symptoms may be circumscribed (eg, attention-seeking behaviors) or may be seen in the context of one or more major psychiatric disorders, including depression; anxiety disorders; obsessive-compulsive disorder; posttraumatic stress disorder; eating disorders; attention-deficit hyperactivity disorders; bipolar disorders; schizophrenia; personality disorders; autism spectrum disorder and other disruptive, impulse-control, and conduct disorders.(49)(50)(51) [DD in Context Link 1, 2, 3, 4]

[EE] Residential withdrawal management allows for management/treatment of withdrawal symptoms in patients who need 24-hour structure and supervision during this process, but who do not require the intensity of clinical services available in a medically monitored or medically managed inpatient service. Residential withdrawal management addresses acute intoxication and withdrawal, while residential care programs provide a drug-free setting focused on psychosocial rehabilitation.(41)(53) [EE in Context Link 1]

[FF] Assessment of risk posed by the recovery environment includes determining the safety of the living situation, the risk of trauma or abuse, the availability of sufficient community resources, or the manner in which the social network (family, friends, caregivers) are or are not supportive of (or actively interfere with) care and management/treatment of the substance use disorder.(3) [FF in Context Link 1]

[GG] Goals for care may be diagnostic, therapeutic, or habilitative in nature. Goals should be agreed upon by the patient (or guardian, as appropriate), and incorporate the patient's perspective on current problems, as well as the patient's specific values and preferences. Lack of progress toward goals should trigger a reassessment of the care plan (eg, determination as to accuracy of the admitting diagnosis, identification of barriers toward progress, incorporation of new problems that may have developed into the treatment plan, assessment of the appropriateness of initial management/treatment strategies), and lead to the modification of the plan as appropriate to promote optimal recovery.(4) [GG in Context Link 1]

[HH] Evaluation of the lack of willingness to participate in treatment (eg, refusal to consent to or participate in treatment) should ascertain whether or not additional efforts to engage the patient in treatment are likely to be successful. It should also include a risk assessment (eg, whether or not the patient would represent a risk to self or others), as well as determine whether or not pursuing involuntary treatment is indicated.(4) [HH in Context Link 1, 2]

[II] Impairments in motivation to participate in treatment, limitations to engagement in care, and resistance to change are common in patients with mental health and substance use disorders, and may represent a feature of the disease process. A lack of motivation may indicate the need for more intensive services in order to help promote recovery or behavior change. Deficits in motivation or resistance to change should be addressed with therapies designed to enhance motivation to participate in treatment and work toward recovery (eg, motivational enhancement therapy). The level of motivation and goals/strategies designed to address motivation should be included in the care plan, and a lack of progress toward goals should trigger a reassessment of the care plan (eg, identification of barriers toward progress, incorporation of new problems that may have developed into the treatment plan, assessment of the appropriateness of initial management strategies), and lead to modification of the plan as appropriate to promote optimal recovery.(4) [II in Context Link 1, 2]

[JJ] The American Society of Addiction Medicine (ASAM) describes Clinically Managed Low-Intensity Residential Treatment as Level 3.1 (ASAM Criteria, Fourth Edition). A variety of facility structures are encompassed at this level of care, including co-occurring capable, co-occurring enhanced, and complexity capable services, which are distinguished by differences in the availability of skilled personnel (mental health, addiction, and medical/nursing) and the anticipated needs of the patient; features common to all service types at this level are 24-hour living support and structure for patients who need to develop skills to support long-term recovery, and the provision of 9 to 19 hours of licensed clinical services each week.(3)(41) The corresponding Level of Care for Alcohol and Drug Treatment Referral 3.0 (LOCADTR 3.0) is Reintegration Services in a Residential Setting.(5) Patients who are assessed likely to require a more extended period of time to develop the skills necessary to support long-term recovery should be considered for admission to Long-Term Community-Based Residential Behavioral Health Level of Care. [BHG.(3)(41) [JJ in Context Link 1]

[KK] The American Society of Addiction Medicine (ASAM) describes Clinically Managed High-Intensity Residential Treatment as Level 3.5 (ASAM Criteria, Fourth Edition), which is designed to support adult patients with multidimensional danger to self or others.(3)(41) Danger in the context of substance use disorders may include the strong probability of continued substance use or relapse, the likelihood of adverse consequences related to use (eg, driving while intoxicated), and the likelihood that the adverse events will occur in the near future (ie, hours to days, rather than weeks to months). Danger also may be due to withdrawal symptoms, biomedical complications, or emotional, cognitive, or behavioral concerns.(1)(3)(4)(41) A variety of facility structures are encompassed at this level of care, including co-occurring capable, co-occurring enhanced, and complexity capable services, which are distinguished by differences in the availability of skilled personnel (mental health, addiction, and medical/nursing) and the anticipated needs of the patient. Features common to all service types at this level are 24-hour availability of trained counselors and intensive therapeutic interventions, which are delivered with the goal of preparing the patient for outpatient treatment.(3)(41) The corresponding Level of Care for Alcohol and Drug Treatment Referral 3.0 (LOCADTR 3.0) is Stabilization Services in a Residential Setting.(5) [KK in Context Link 1]

[LL] The American Society of Addiction Medicine (ASAM) describes Medically Managed Residential Treatment as Level 3.7 (ASAM Criteria, Fourth Edition), which is designed for adult patients who require 24-hour nursing care and physician availability to support acute intoxication or withdrawal or comorbidities (eg, medical, cognitive, psychiatric, behavioral, or emotional conditions), and often is referred to as subacute care. Structured clinical services are available 20 hours each week at this level.(3)(41) Patients appropriate for ASAM Level 3.7 generally require medication management (either to address withdrawal symptoms or for active treatment of comorbid conditions), and also may have a history of withdrawal management that has not been adequately addressed at a less intensive level of service. A variety of facility structures are encompassed at this level of care, including co-occurring capable, co-occurring enhanced, and complexity capable services, which are distinguished by differences in the availability of skilled personnel (mental health, addiction, and medical/nursing) and the anticipated needs of the patient.(3)(41) The corresponding Level of Care for Alcohol and Drug Treatment Referral 3.0 (LOCADTR 3.0) is Medically Supervised Inpatient Detoxification.(5) [LL in Context Link 1]

[MM] A variety of factors may impact the ability of the patient to respond to treatment, including language, cognitive, and intellectual capacity, as well as the presence of any developmental conditions. Assessment of the ability to respond to planned interventions may be useful to identify subgroups of patients more likely to respond to particular treatments, and help optimize (or modify) the care plan to increase the likelihood of successful recovery. It may also help determine if a specialized treatment setting (eg, dual-diagnosis program) or alternative level of care would be more appropriate to address the patient's needs. Patients who do not initially respond to scheduled therapeutic interventions may respond to modifications of the treatment plans or strategies designed to enhance ability. These include the addition or substitution of a new medication or psychosocial therapy; adjustment of the medication dose; increase in service intensity (some patients require higher levels of service intensity to provide reinforcement to enhance motivation and promote change) or decrease in service intensity (some patients may find higher levels of service intensity so restrictive as to be burdensome and hinder recovery).(4) [MM in Context Link 1]

[NN] Biopsychosocial stressors may impact the level of care necessary to manage a psychiatric or behavioral condition, including the ability of the program to meet comprehensive patient needs, ensure treatment adherence, enhance motivation, or prevent relapse (ie, comorbidities, environmental factors, or other barriers may prevent effective treatment at a less intensive level of care than might otherwise be appropriate to the patient's condition). Biopsychosocial assessment factors should be incorporated into care planning, including planned treatment goals, and intensity and duration of interventions. A "whole person care" approach that coordinates care across physical health, behavioral health, and social service sectors may bridge the gap of physical and mental health.(36)(37)(38)(39) Any identified deficits should be manageable/treatable by the program directly or through alternative arrangements.(4)(9)(11)(12) [NN in Context Link 1]

[OO] Participation motivated by a wish to avoid negative consequences rather than accept the need to work toward recovery may require more intense monitoring and follow-up.(1)(3)(41) The patient's level of engagement may be described on a continuum: optimal, positive, limited, minimal, or unengaged. Readiness to change may range from actively and willingly engaged to unable to follow treatment recommendations due to clinical condition.(3)(4)(9)(11)(12) [OO in Context Link 1]

[PP] The purpose of the care guidelines is to promote evidence-based care across the continuum of care to enhance the delivery of quality healthcare. Indications are presented for different levels of care. These indications help define the optimal level of care and can assist in developing alternatives to higher levels of care, tracking patient progress during treatment within a level of care, facilitating the progress of patients whose recovery is delayed, and preparing comprehensive plans for transition of patients from one level of care to another. Relevant professional society guidelines are foundational content for evaluation and treatment of behavioral health disorders at different levels of care and are complemented by the best available published evidence.(4)(9)(10)(11)(12)(13)(14)(15)(52) [PP in Context Link 1, 2, 3]

[QQ] Observation care can be provided in a psychiatric emergency services unit, holding unit, or other facility-based setting; or in a dedicated observation care unit or other hospital-based setting.(64)(65) [QQ in Context Link 1]

[RR] Comorbid conditions may directly impact the experience of psychiatric symptoms (eg, COPD and anxiety), or may indirectly impact determination of the appropriate venue for care (eg, routine blood sugar and insulin management in people with diabetes). If clinically appropriate, testing related to diagnosis or management (eg, screening for liver and kidney function, hepatitis, HIV, syphilis, tuberculosis) may be performed off-site.(4)(9)(11)(12) Assessment and treatment of co-occurring medical and/or developmental conditions through services and treatment settings capable of rendering integrated care is recommended.(4)(9)(10)(11)(12)(13) A "whole person care" approach that coordinates care across physical health, behavioral health, and social service sectors may bridge the gap of physical and mental health.(36)(37)(38)(39) The level that comorbid medical and/or developmental conditions are present may be described on a continuum (none/absent, low, moderate, and severe) and may impact determination of the appropriate level of care for treatment (ie, admission to a higher level of care).(4)(9)(11)(12)(66) [RR in Context Link 1, 2, 3]

[SS] Evaluation/assessment and treatment of co-occurring substance use disorders through services and treatment settings capable of rendering integrated care is recommended.(4)(9)(10)(11)(12) A "whole person care" approach that coordinates care across physical health, behavioral health, and social service sectors may bridge the gap of physical and mental health.(36)(37)(38)(39) The level that comorbid substance use disorders contribute to the primary presenting condition may be described on a continuum (none/absent, low, moderate, and severe) and may impact determination of the appropriate level of care for treatment (ie, admission to a higher level of care or specialty dual-diagnosis program).(4)(9)(11)(12)(66) [SS in Context Link 1, 2, 3]

[TT] The degree of environmental stressors and amount of support in the patient recovery environment should be considered in the context of the clinical presentation in determining the appropriate level of care for treatment. The level of environmental stressors may be low, mild, moderate, high, or extreme. The level of support in the environment may range from absent or minimal to limited to supportive or highly supportive.(4)(9)(10)(11)(12)(13)(66) [TT in Context Link 1, 2, 3]

[UU] Participation motivated by a wish to avoid negative consequences rather than accept the need to work toward recovery may require more intense monitoring and follow-up.(52)(61)(66) The patient's level of engagement may be described on a continuum: optimal, positive, limited, minimal, or unengaged. Readiness to change may range from actively and willingly engaged to unable to follow treatment recommendations due to clinical condition.(4)(9)(11)(12)(66) [UU in Context Link 1, 2, 3]

[VV] Short-term (1 to 3 days) crisis stabilization can be accomplished by crisis intervention care that can be done in a facility setting (eg, residential care, short-term psychiatric unit) or by outreach teams.(54)(67)(68) For voluntary patients with acute manifestations of psychiatric disorders who are being considered for inpatient admission because of clinical urgency but are not expected to require physical restraint or around-the-clock nursing care, randomized controlled trials have shown that a residential setting can provide treatment that is no less effective than inpatient care.(67)(69)(70) [VV in Context Link 1]

[WW] Acute interventions may address multiple factors contributing to a patient's condition including medication needs, identification of needed resources and support, or change in living situation.(73) [WW in Context Link 1]

[XX] Goals for care may be diagnostic, therapeutic, or rehabilitative in nature. Goals should be agreed upon by the patient (or guardian, as appropriate), and incorporate the patient's perspective on current problems, as well as the patient's specific values and preferences. Lack of progress toward goals should trigger a reassessment of the care plan (eg, determination as to accuracy of the admitting diagnosis, identification of barriers toward progress, incorporation of new problems that may have developed into the treatment plan, assessment of the appropriateness of initial management strategies), and lead to the modification of the plan as appropriate to promote optimal recovery.(15)(79) [XX in Context Link 1, 2]

[YY] Evaluation of the lack of willingness to participate in treatment (eg, refusal to consent to or participate in treatment) should ascertain whether or not additional efforts to engage the patient in treatment are likely to be successful. It should also include a risk assessment (eg, whether or not the patient would represent a risk to self or others), as well as determine whether or not pursuing involuntary treatment is indicated.(4)(9)(11)(12) [YY in Context Link 1, 2]

[ZZ] Impairments in motivation to participate in treatment, limitations to engagement in care, and resistance to change are common in patients with mental health and substance use disorders, and may represent a feature of the disease process. A lack of motivation may indicate the need for more intensive services in order to help promote recovery or behavior change. Deficits in motivation or resistance to change should be addressed with therapies designed to enhance motivation to participate in treatment and work toward recovery (eg, motivational enhancement therapy). The level of motivation and goals/strategies designed to address motivation should be included in the care plan, and a lack of progress toward goals should trigger a reassessment of the care plan (eg, identification of barriers toward progress, incorporation of new problems which may have developed into the treatment plan, assessment of the appropriateness of initial management strategies), and lead to modification of the plan as appropriate to promote optimal recovery.(79)(80) [ZZ in Context Link 1, 2]

[AAA] A variety of factors may impact the ability of the patient to respond to treatment, including language, cognitive, and intellectual capacity, as well as the presence of any developmental conditions. Assessment of the ability to respond to planned interventions may help identify subgroups of patients more likely to respond to particular treatments, and help optimize (or modify) the care plan to increase the likelihood of successful recovery. It may also help determine if a specialized treatment setting (eg, dual-diagnosis program) or alternative level of care would be more appropriate to address the patient's needs. Patients who do not initially respond to scheduled therapeutic interventions may respond to modifications of the treatment plans or strategies designed to enhance ability. These include the addition or substitution of a new medication or psychosocial therapy, adjustment of the medication dose, increase in service intensity (some patients require higher levels of service intensity to provide reinforcement to enhance motivation and promote change), or decrease in service intensity (some patients may find higher levels of service intensity so restrictive as to be burdensome and hinder recovery).(4)(9)(11)(12) (66)(79)(80) [AAA in Context Link 1, 2]

[BBB] Partial hospital programs (PHPs) provide multidisciplinary behavioral care and are staffed similarly to the day shift of an inpatient unit. Patients in PHPs generally receive services for 6 to 8 hours per day, 5 to 7 days per week (with patients going home each evening or weekend).(4)(15) [BBB in Context Link 1]

[CCC] The American Society of Addiction Medicine (ASAM) describes High-Intensity Outpatient Treatment as Level 2.5 (ASAM Criteria, Fourth Edition). This level of care provides a minimum of 20 hours of addiction-focused clinical services each week for adult patients on a unit that is staffed similarly to the day shift of an inpatient unit, and is designed to address multidimensional deficits in people with substance-related disorders and comorbid conditions who do not require 24-hour care.(3)(81) The corresponding Level of Care for Alcohol and Drug Treatment Referral 3.0 (LOCADTR 3.0) is Outpatient Day Rehabilitation.(5) [CCC in Context Link 1]

[DDD] The American Society of Addiction Medicine (ASAM) describes Medically Managed Intensive Outpatient Treatment as Level 2.7 (ASAM Criteria, Fourth Edition). This level of care provides a minimum of 20 hours of addiction-focused clinical services each week, and is designed for adult patients who require physician availability to support acute intoxication/withdrawal, comorbidities (eg, medical, cognitive, psychiatric, behavioral, or emotional conditions), or the initiation of medications, but who do not require 24-hour care.(3)(81) The corresponding Level of Care for Alcohol and Drug Treatment Referral 3.0 (LOCADTR 3.0) is Outpatient Day Rehabilitation.(5) [DDD in Context Link 1]

[EEE] A practice guideline for partial hospital and intensive outpatient care indicates that admission to a partial hospital program may be preferable to an intensive outpatient program if daily or near daily management/treatment or immediate intervention is necessary. Conditions that may require this intensity of monitoring include medication and comprehensive symptom management; observation and safety planning due to danger to self or others; lack of resiliency and need for repeated reinforcement; extreme mood swings, hopelessness, or isolation with inadequate or unavailable community supports; and substance use monitoring. Immediate intervention may be necessary for crisis situations (eg, volatile family situations) or when urgent behavioral activation is required (eg, rapid improvement is necessary to return the individual to vital role functioning).(15) [EEE in Context Link 1]

[FFF] Partial hospital program care is appropriate to address intensification of addiction symptoms (cravings) that pose a high risk for relapse or continued use without near-daily monitoring and support.(4) (81) [FFF in Context Link 1]

[GGG] Patients appropriate for partial hospital program care have poor engagement in treatment, significant ambivalence, or lack of awareness of their problem with substance use, and require daily substance use monitoring (and intensive services provided in a partial hospital program) to promote progress through the stages of change. Participation motivated by the wish to avoid negative consequences rather than acceptance of the need to work toward recovery may require more intense monitoring and follow-up.(15)(81) [GGG in Context Link 1]

[HHH] Examples of a moderately stressful environment include difficulty in the family living situation (eg, decreased ability of the primary caregiver to meet care needs), significant loss of material resources (eg, loss of job), sustained decline in health status, danger or threat in the neighborhood, easy exposure to drugs or alcohol, or exposure to substance use.(3)(4)(15) [HHH in Context Link 1]

[III] Assessment and treatment of co-occurring medical and/or developmental conditions through services and treatment settings capable of rendering integrated care is recommended.(4)(9)(10)(11)(12)(13) A "whole person care" approach that coordinates care across physical health, behavioral health, and social service sectors may bridge the gap of physical and mental health.(36)(37)(38)(39) The level that comorbid medical and/or developmental conditions are present may be described on a continuum (none/absent, low, moderate, and severe) and may impact determination of the appropriate level of care for treatment (ie, admission to a higher level of care).(3)(4)(9)(11)(12) [III in Context Link 1, 2, 3]

[JJJ] An example of a medical condition appropriate for partial hospital care is asthma that is anticipated to require medication adjustment during the course of treatment.(4) [JJJ in Context Link 1]

[KKK] A practice guideline for partial hospital and intensive outpatient care indicates that admission to a partial hospital program may be preferable to an intensive outpatient program if daily or near daily management or immediate intervention is necessary. Conditions that may require this intensity of monitoring include medication and comprehensive symptom management; observation and safety planning due to danger to self or others; lack of resiliency and need for repeated reinforcement; extreme mood swings, hopelessness, or isolation with inadequate or unavailable community supports; and substance use monitoring. Immediate intervention may be necessary for crisis situations (eg, volatile family situations) or when urgent behavioral activation is required (eg, rapid improvement is necessary to return the individual to vital role functioning).(15) [KKK in Context Link 1, 2]

[LLL] A practice guideline for partial hospital and intensive outpatient care indicates that admission to a partial hospital or an intensive outpatient program is inappropriate if the patient's needs are primarily social, custodial, recreational, or respite.(15) [LLL in Context Link 1, 2]

[MMM] Goals for care may be diagnostic, therapeutic, or rehabilitative in nature. Goals should be agreed upon by the patient, and incorporate the patient's perspective on current problems, as well as the patient's specific values and preferences. Lack of progress toward goals should trigger a reassessment of the care plan (eg, determination as to the accuracy of the admitting diagnosis, identification of barriers toward progress, incorporation of new problems that may have developed into the treatment plan, assessment of the appropriateness of initial management strategies), and lead to the modification of the plan as appropriate to promote optimal recovery.(4)(15) [MMM in Context Link 1, 2]

[NNN] Evaluation of the lack of willingness to participate in treatment (eg, refusal to consent to or participate in treatment) should ascertain whether or not additional efforts to engage the patient in treatment are likely to be successful. It should also include a risk assessment (eg, whether or not the patient would represent a risk to self or others), as well as determine whether or not pursuing involuntary treatment is indicated.(4)(15) [NNN in Context Link 1, 2]

[OOO] Impairments in motivation to participate in treatment, limitations to engagement in care, and resistance to change are common in patients with mental health and substance use disorders, and may represent a feature of the disease process. A lack of motivation may indicate the need for more intensive services in order to help promote recovery or behavior change. Deficits in motivation or resistance to change should be addressed with therapies designed to enhance motivation to participate in treatment and work toward recovery (eg, motivational enhancement therapy). The level of motivation and goals/strategies designed to address motivation should be included in the care plan, and a lack of progress toward goals should trigger a reassessment of the care plan (eg, identification of barriers toward progress, incorporation of new problems that may have developed into the treatment plan, assessment of the appropriateness of initial management strategies), and lead to modification of the plan as appropriate to promote optimal recovery.(4)(15) [OOO in Context Link 1, 2]

[PPP] A practice guideline for partial hospital and intensive outpatient care indicates that inappropriate candidates for intensive outpatient and partial hospital programs include patients (or parents/guardians, as appropriate) who are uninterested or unable to engage in identifying goals for treatment, contract for behavioral change, or engage in a mutually agreed treatment plan.(15) [PPP in Context Link 1, 2, 3]

[QQQ] Partial hospital program staff should verify that support persons are able to conduct any necessary monitoring of the patient's condition, provide instruction regarding the symptoms and behaviors to be monitored, and specify actions to be taken if the patient develops a current plan for suicide or serious harm.(4)(15) [QQQ in Context Link 1]

[RRR] A variety of factors may impact the ability of the patient to respond to treatment, including language, cognitive, and intellectual capacity, as well as the presence of any developmental conditions. Assessment of the ability to respond to planned interventions may help identify subgroups of patients more likely to respond to particular treatments, and help optimize (or modify) the care plan to increase the likelihood of successful recovery. It may also help determine if a specialized treatment setting (eg, dual-diagnosis program) or alternative level of care would be more appropriate to address the patient's needs. Patients who do not initially respond to scheduled therapeutic interventions may respond to modifications of the treatment plans or strategies designed to enhance ability. These include the addition or substitution of a new medication or psychosocial therapy, adjustment of the medication dose, increase in service intensity (some patients require higher levels of service intensity to provide reinforcement to enhance motivation and promote change), or decrease in service intensity (some patients may find higher levels of service intensity so restrictive as to be burdensome and hinder recovery).(4) [RRR in Context Link 1, 2, 3]

[SSS] A practice guideline for partial hospital and intensive outpatient care indicates that inappropriate candidates for intensive outpatient or partial hospital programs include patients with cognitive dysfunction or a developmental level that precludes the integration of newly learned information, skills, or behavioral change; patients with conditions (eg, social phobia, mania, anxiety, paranoia) assessed likely to be aggravated by care plans that emphasize the role of group treatment; and patients with lack of adherence (either due to unwillingness or lack of ability) to program expectations and personal responsibilities in a manner anticipated to negatively impact group functioning.(15) [SSS in Context Link 1, 2]

[TTT] Intensive outpatient programs for the treatment of substance-related disorders in adults provide treatment for 9 to 19 hours per week for recovery and to treat multidimensional instability.(1)(3)(4)(81) Multidimensional factors may include withdrawal symptoms, biomedical complications, or emotional, cognitive, or behavioral concerns.(3) [TTT in Context Link 1]

[UUU] The American Society of Addiction Medicine (ASAM) describes intensive outpatient treatment as Level 2.1 (ASAM Criteria, Fourth Edition). This level of care provides a minimum of 9 hours of services each week for adult patients, and is designed to address multidimensional deficits in people with substance-related disorders and comorbid conditions.(3)(81) The corresponding Level of Care for Alcohol and Drug Treatment Referral 3.0 (LOCADTR 3.0) is Intensive Outpatient.(5) [UUU in Context Link 1]

[VVV] IOP is appropriate to address intensification of addiction symptoms (cravings) that pose a high risk for relapse or continued use without monitoring and support at least 1 to 2 times per week, but who do not require the daily (or near daily) supervision and treatment interventions that would be provided in a partial hospital program.(4)(81) [VVV in Context Link 1]

[WWW] Patients appropriate for an intensive outpatient program have variable engagement in treatment, ambivalence, or lack of awareness of their problem with substance use. They require treatment in a substance treatment program at least 1 to 2 times per week (but do not require the daily, or near daily, contact that would be provided in a partial hospital program) in order to promote progress through the stages of change. Participation motivated by a wish to avoid negative consequences rather than acceptance of the need to work toward recovery may require more intense monitoring and follow-up.(3)(4)(15) [WWW in Context Link 1]

[XXX] Examples of mild to moderate environmental stressors include acute stress due to normal transition (eg, new job), minor interpersonal loss (eg, loss of peer relationship due to move), transient but significant illness (eg, fractured bone), somewhat inadequate material resources, performance expectations that create discomfort, or potential for exposure to substance use.(3)(4)(15) [XXX in Context Link 1]

[YYY] Examples of medical conditions appropriate for intensive outpatient care include mild pregnancy-related hypertension, asthma, hypertension, or diabetes that are being treated on stable medication regimens and not anticipated to require adjustment during the course of treatment.(4) [YYY in Context Link 1]

[ZZZ] Outpatient care consists of pharmacologic and/or psychosocial treatment services provided in office or clinic settings (or through consultation to an assisted living, custodial care, or other special care program or facility) for managing care of behavioral health disorders. Visit frequencies are flexible and determined on the basis of individual patient needs.(1)(4)(10)(83)(84) [ZZZ in Context Link 1]

[AAAA] The American Society of Addiction Medicine (ASAM) describes Outpatient Therapy as Level 1.5 (ASAM Criteria, Fourth Edition). This level of care provides fewer than 9 hours of services each week for adult patients, and is designed to provide outpatient psychosocial services for patients with mild substance use problems and for patients in early remission.(3)(81) The corresponding Level of Care for Alcohol and Drug Treatment Referral 3.0 (LOCADTR 3.0) is Outpatient Clinic.(5) [AAAA in Context Link 1]

[BBBB] The American Society of Addiction Medicine (ASAM) describes Medically Managed Outpatient Treatment as Level 1.7 (ASAM Criteria, Fourth Edition). This level of care provides fewer than 9 hours of services each week for adult patients, and is designed for patients who require physician availability to support acute intoxication/withdrawal, comorbidities (eg, medical, cognitive, psychiatric, behavioral, or emotional conditions), or the initiation of medications.(3)(81) The corresponding Level of Care for Alcohol and Drug Treatment Referral 3.0 (LOCADTR 3.0) is Outpatient Clinic.(5) [BBBB in Context Link 1]

[CCCC] Outpatient care is appropriate if the patient requires only minimal support to maintain abstinence and is assessed to be at low risk of relapse.(4)(81) [CCCC in Context Link 1]

[DDDD] Barriers to change appropriate to outpatient care include the need for motivational enhancement and monitoring strategies (despite readiness for recovery). Participation motivated by a wish to avoid negative consequences rather than acceptance of the need to work toward recovery may require more intense monitoring and follow-up.(1)(3)(4) [DDDD in Context Link 1]

[EEEE] Environmental stressors appropriate for outpatient care may include some transitions or losses (eg, change in job) that are not acute, and family or community resources are adequate to provide support.(3)(4) [EEEE in Context Link 1]

[FFFF] Examples of medical conditions appropriate for outpatient care include uncomplicated pregnancy or HIV-positive status without symptoms.(4) [FFFF in Context Link 1]

[GGGG] Goals for care may be diagnostic, therapeutic, or habilitative in nature. Goals should be agreed upon by the patient (or guardian, as appropriate), and incorporate the patient's perspective on current problems, as well as the patient's specific values and preferences. Lack of progress toward goals should trigger a reassessment of the care plan (eg, determination as to the accuracy of the admitting diagnosis, identification of barriers toward progress, incorporation of new problems that may have developed into the treatment plan, assessment of the appropriateness of initial management strategies), and lead to the modification of the plan as appropriate to promote optimal recovery.(4) [GGGG in Context Link 1]

[HHHH] Day treatment consists of a community-based mix of psychosocial treatment (including individual, family, and group-based psychotherapy), educational, and recreational activities for patients with behavioral health conditions associated with functional impairment (eg, inability to maintain full-time engagement in work, school, or home environment as appropriate). This level of care typically is monitored by staff whose licensure and credentials (eg, nurses, social workers) is allowed for this role by local statutes and is clinically appropriate to patient needs.(40)(85)(86)(87) Day treatment is designed to address issues that are chronic in nature, rather than acute exacerbations or urgent clinical issues; services tend to overlap with regular school or work schedules, and typically are of longer duration than intensive outpatient or partial hospital programs (eg, an adolescent in day treatment may be enrolled in a program that lasts for the entire school year).(40)(85)(86)(87) [HHHH in Context Link 1]

[IIII] For some patients, day treatment programs provide a period of transition from a more intensive level of care and assist the patient in reintegrating into the community, as enrollment in day treatment following hospitalization has been associated with a decrease in the risk of rehospitalization.(40)(88) While patients for whom day treatment is indicated do not require the intensity of services available in an intensive outpatient or partial hospital program, some day treatment programs provide diagnostic, medical, psychiatric, or other adjunctive treatment modalities, either directly or through arrangements made by the program. These services may be provided over an extended period of time.(85) [IIII in Context Link 1]

[JJJJ] **Substance-related disorders:** Specialty centers providing outpatient treatment for substance use disorders commonly do so in day treatment centers.(52) Day treatment is appropriate to support abstinence and decrease the risk of relapse, including the promotion of strategies for the management of addiction symptoms (cravings) that pose a risk for relapse but do not require the level of support that would be provided in an intensive outpatient program.(4)(40)(52)(89) Patients appropriate for day treatment may require motivational enhancement and monitoring strategies to address barriers to change (despite at least some readiness for recovery) to help support engagement in treatment and promote continued progress through the stages of change, but do not require the level of support that would be provided in an intensive outpatient program.(4)(15)(52) Patients with substance use disorders who are appropriate for day treatment are generally resilient and require only minimal support to manage any deficits in the environment.(4)(9)(11)(12) Examples of mild environmental stressors include stress due to normal transition (eg, new school, new job), minor interpersonal loss (eg, loss of peer relationship due to move), transient but significant illness (eg, fractured bone), somewhat inadequate material resources, performance expectations that create discomfort, or potential for exposure to substance use.(4)(9)(11)(12)(52) [JJJJ in Context Link 1]

[KKKK] **Eating disorders:** Patients appropriate for day treatment for eating disorders do not require the level of monitoring that would be provided in an intensive outpatient or partial hospital program (staff supervision of meals is not required), and any supervision of meals that is determined to be clinically appropriate may be provided by family, caregivers, or other supports.(15)(79) [KKKK in Context Link 1]

[LLLL] Determination of severity may be based on symptom severity alone (including intensity or frequency of symptoms and the extent to which they interfere with functioning), or may be due to other factors (eg, comorbid medical illness, developmental condition, cognitive impairment, substance use disorder, or other factors that contribute to destabilization or decreased ability to cope with the underlying behavioral health disorder). If the comorbidity affects the level of care appropriate to meet the patient's behavioral health needs, the manner in which it impacts the behavioral health condition (and how the comorbidity will be managed at the proposed level of care) should be documented in order to optimize comprehensive patient care.(4)(9)(10)(11)(12) [LLLL in Context Link 1]

[MMMM] Assessment for comorbid conditions should take place at admission evaluation, and any identified conditions should be manageable by the program (either directly or through alternative arrangements). Comorbidities requiring more active management or that currently distract the patient from therapy or have been associated with challenges in treatment follow-through in the past should prompt consideration of a program designed to provide treatment for both disorders (eg, a dual-diagnosis program).(4)(9)(10)(11)(12)(20) [MMMM in Context Link 1]

[NNNN] The diagnosis and severity of depressive disorders may be confirmed and documented by the use of standardized rating scales that reliably measure depressive symptoms. For adults, these scales include the Beck Depression Inventory (BDI), the Hamilton Depression Rating Scale (HDRS), the Patient Health Questionnaire-9 (PHQ-9) in the primary care setting, the Montgomery-Asberg Depression Rating Scale (MADRS), and the Geriatric Depression Scale (GDS) for older adults.(90)(91)(92) For children and adolescents, these include the BDI, the Children's Depression Inventory (CDI), and the PHQ-9 modified for adolescents (PHQ-A).(93)(94)(95) As an example, the PHQ-9 and PHQ-A ask the patient to describe the frequency of 9 symptoms over the past 2 weeks on a scale of 0 to 3 (0 = not at all, 1 = several days, 2 = more than half the days, 3 = nearly every day), and depression severity is scored as follows: 0 to 4 none, 5 to 9 mild, 10 to 14 moderate, 15 to 19 moderately severe, and 20 to 27 severe.(96) In addition to screening, rating scales are often administered throughout treatment to measure changes in symptoms. An approximate 50% decrease in scores on the BDI, HDRS, PHQ-9/PHQ-A, or the MADRS has been found to be clinically significant when reassessing an individual for interval improvement.(91)(93)(97) [NNNN in Context Link 1]

[OOOO] Patients with recent substantial increases in signs and symptoms related to the underlying diagnosis or recent deterioration in function should be considered for a program with a greater level of service intensity (eg, an intensive outpatient or partial hospital program or other higher level of care).(85) [OOOO in Context Link 1]

[PPPP] Assessment of the likelihood of benefit at the proposed level of care may help identify subgroups of patients more likely to respond to particular treatments and help optimize the care plan to increase the likelihood of successful recovery. It may also help determine if a specialized treatment setting (eg, dual-diagnosis program) or a different level of service intensity would be more appropriate to address the patient's needs.(4)(9)(11)(12)(52)(79) [PPPP in Context Link 1]

[QQQQ] Evidence is inconclusive for animal-assisted interventions for autism spectrum disorder and mental health conditions based on heterogeneity in interventions, methodological weaknesses, small sample sizes, and lack of randomization within studies.(98)(99) [QQQQ in Context Link 1]

Definitions

Anxiety (adult)

- Multiple instruments are available to assess anxiety severity. The General Anxiety Disorder-7 (GAD-7) asks the patient to describe the frequency of 7 symptoms over the past 2 weeks on a scale of 0 to 3 (0 = not at all, 1 = several days, 2 = more than half the days, 3 = nearly every day). A score of 5 to 9 suggests mild anxiety; 10 to 14, moderate anxiety; and 15 or greater, severe anxiety.(1) Examples of anxiety symptoms include(2):
 - Feeling nervous, anxious, or on edge
 - Not being able to stop or control worrying
 - Worrying too much about different things
 - Trouble relaxing
 - Being so restless that it is hard to sit still
 - Becoming easily annoyed or irritable
 - Feeling afraid, as if something awful might happen

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Anxiety (child or adolescent)

- Multiple instruments are available to assess anxiety severity, including the Multidimensional Anxiety Scale for Children-2nd Edition (MASC 2), the Screen for Child Anxiety-Related Emotional Disorders (SCARED), and the Spence Children's Anxiety Scale (SCAS).(1)(2)(3)(4)(5) Examples of anxiety symptoms include(6):
 - Nervousness
 - Feeling on edge
 - Inability to stop worrying or excessive worrying
 - Being told by others that one worries too much
 - Trouble relaxing
 - Inability to sit still due to restlessness
 - Easily irritable or annoyed
 - Feeling afraid that something awful might happen
 - Feeling frightened for no reason
 - Feeling afraid to be alone in the house
 - Feeling scared to go to school

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Command auditory hallucinations

- An auditory hallucination is a "false perception of sound." This is the most common type of hallucination in psychiatric disorders and typically consists of voices but also may consist of any type of sound. A command auditory hallucination is a false perception of a voice giving orders to the patient that they may feel compelled to obey. Likely adherence to a command auditory hallucination is indicated by **1 or more** of the following(1)(2)(3)(4):
 - Perceived familiar or benevolent source
 - No belief by patient in their ability to control the voices
 - History of frequent response to such hallucinations with unquestioning obedience

References

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Current plan

- Determining the existence of current plan for suicide, homicide, or serious harm to self or another involves clinical judgment regarding multiple factors. Higher risk may be indicated by a combination of factors including explicit or implicit evidence of **1 or more** of the following(1)(2):
 - Identification and/or availability of severe or lethal method (eg, using a gun)
 - Preparatory acts (eg, writing suicide note)
 - Intention that act will have severe or fatal outcome evidenced by planning where and when action will be taken (eg, act unlikely to be discovered and likely to be fatal)

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Danger to others for adult

- Danger to others for adult is present due to **1 or more** of the following(1)(2)(3):
 - Command auditory hallucinations or paranoid delusions contributing to risk for homicide or serious Harm to another
 - Patient has persistent thoughts of homicide or serious Harm to another that cannot be adequately monitored or treated at lower level of care, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following(A):
 - Necessary behavioral health care (such as required provider or lower level of care) not available or insufficient
 - Patient support system inadequate
 - Patient characteristics, such as moderately severe to severely Impaired impulse control, judgment, or insight; moderate to moderately severe Mania (adult) or unreliability
 - Indication or report of significant physical or sexual aggression with Impaired impulse control, judgment, or insight that significantly endangers another
 - Current homicidal ideation with either clearly expressed intentions or past history of carrying out such behavior

References

- American Association of Community Psychiatrists. Level of Care Utilization System for Psychiatric and Addiction Services (LOCUS). Adult version 20 [Internet] American Association of Community Psychiatrists. 2016 Dec Accessed at: <https://www.communitypsychiatry.org/keystone-programs/locus>. [accessed 2023 Sep 11]

2. APA Work Group on Psychiatric Evaluation. The American Psychiatric Association practice Guidelines for the Psychiatric Evaluation of Adults. 3rd edition [Internet] American Psychiatric Association. 2016 Accessed at: <https://psychiatryonline.org/>. [accessed 2023 Sep 21] DOI: 10.1176/appi.books.9780890426760.
3. The Assessment and Management of Suicide Risk Work Group. VA/DoD Clinical Practice Guideline for the Assessment and Management of Patients at Risk for Suicide. VA/DoD Evidence Based Practice [Internet] U.S. Department of Veteran Affairs and the Department of Defense. Version 2.0; 2019 Accessed at: <https://www.healthquality.va.gov/guidelines/>. [accessed 2023 May 15]

Footnotes

- A. Patients with persistent thoughts of suicide, homicide, or serious harm to self or another may need frequent monitoring for progression to planning or intention to act on their thoughts. Such monitoring can be safely conducted at an outpatient level of care if providers and supports are adequately available and the patient can reliably participate in the monitoring process.(2)

Danger to others for child or adolescent

- Danger to others for child or adolescent is present due to **1 or more** of the following(1)(2)(3)(4)(5)(6):
 - Command auditory hallucinations or paranoid delusions contributing to risk for homicide or serious Harm to another
 - Patient has persistent thoughts of homicide or serious Harm to another that cannot be adequately monitored or treated at lower level of care, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following[A]:
 - Necessary child or adolescent behavioral health care (such as required provider or lower level of care) not available or insufficient
 - Conflict in family environment or other inadequacy in patient support system
 - Patient characteristics, such as moderately severe to severely Impaired impulse control, judgment, or insight; moderate to moderately severe Mania (child or adolescent) or unreliability
 - Indication or report of significant physical or sexual aggression with Impaired impulse control, judgment, or insight that significantly endangers another
 - Current homicidal ideation with either clearly expressed intentions or past history of carrying out such behavior

References

1. American Association of Community Psychiatrists. CALOCUS/CASII: Child and Adolescent Level of Care Utilization System. Child and Adolescent Version 20 [Internet] American Association of Community Psychiatrists. 2019 Jul Accessed at: <https://www.communitypsychiatry.org/keystone-programs/locus>. [accessed 2023 Sep 08]
2. CASII. Child and Adolescent Service Intensity Instrument [Internet] American Academy of Child and Adolescent Psychiatry. Accessed at: https://www.aacap.org/aacap/Member_Resources/Practice_Information/CASII.aspx. [accessed 2023 Sep 25]
3. Child & Adolescent Service Intensity Instrument (CASII) User's Manual version 4.0. American Academy of Child and Adolescent Psychiatry 2014 Oct.
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5. Shain B, Committee on Adolescence. Suicide and suicide attempts in adolescents. Pediatrics 2016;138(1):e20161420. DOI: 10.1542/peds.2016-1420. (Reaffirmed 2023 Jul)
6. The Assessment and Management of Suicide Risk Work Group. VA/DoD Clinical Practice Guideline for the Assessment and Management of Patients at Risk for Suicide. VA/DoD Evidence Based Practice [Internet] U.S. Department of Veteran Affairs and the Department of Defense. Version 2.0; 2019 Accessed at: <https://www.healthquality.va.gov/guidelines/>. [accessed 2023 May 15]
7. Sewall CJR, Goldstein TR, Brent DA. Youth suicide. In: Dulcan MK, editor. Dulcan's Textbook of Child and Adolescent Psychiatry. 3rd ed. American Psychiatric Association Publishing; 2022:551-564.

Footnotes

- A. Patients with persistent thoughts of suicide, homicide, or serious harm to self or another may need frequent monitoring for progression to planning or intention to act on their thoughts. Such monitoring can be safely conducted at an outpatient level of care if providers and supports are adequately available and the patient can reliably participate in the monitoring process.(7)

Danger to self for adult

- Danger to self for adult is present due to **1 or more** of the following(1)(2)(3):
 - Command auditory hallucinations contributing to risk for suicide or serious Harm to self
 - Patient has persistent Thoughts of suicide or serious Harm to self that cannot be adequately monitored or treated at lower level of care as indicated by **1 or more** of the following[A]:
 - Necessary behavioral health care (such as required provider or lower level of care) not available or insufficient
 - Patient support system inadequate
 - Patient characteristics, such as moderately severe to severely Impaired impulse control, judgment, or insight; moderate to moderately severe Mania (adult) or unreliability
 - Indication or report of significant physical or sexual risky behavior with Impaired impulse control, judgment, or insight that significantly endangers self

References

1. American Association of Community Psychiatrists. Level of Care Utilization System for Psychiatric and Addiction Services (LOCUS). Adult version 20 [Internet] American Association of Community Psychiatrists. 2016 Dec Accessed at: <https://www.communitypsychiatry.org/keystone-programs/locus>. [accessed 2023 Sep 11]
2. APA Work Group on Psychiatric Evaluation. The American Psychiatric Association practice Guidelines for the Psychiatric Evaluation of Adults. 3rd edition [Internet] American Psychiatric Association. 2016 Accessed at: <https://psychiatryonline.org/>. [accessed 2023 Sep 21] DOI: 10.1176/appi.books.9780890426760.
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Footnotes

- A. Patients with persistent thoughts of suicide, homicide, or serious harm to self or another may need frequent monitoring for progression to planning or intention to act on their thoughts. Such monitoring can be safely conducted at an outpatient level of care if providers and supports are adequately available and the patient can reliably participate in the monitoring process.(2)

Danger to self for child or adolescent

- Danger to self for child or adolescent is present due to **1 or more** of the following(1)(2)(3)(4)(5)(6):
 - Command auditory hallucinations contributing to risk for suicide or serious Harm to self(4)
 - Patient has persistent Thoughts of suicide or serious Harm to self that cannot be adequately monitored or treated at lower level of care as indicated by **1 or more** of the following[A]:
 - Necessary child or adolescent behavioral health care (such as required provider or lower level of care) not available or insufficient
 - Conflict in family environment or other inadequacy in patient support system
 - Patient characteristics, such as moderately severe to severely Impaired impulse control, judgment, or insight; moderate to moderately severe Mania (child or adolescent) or unreliability
 - Indication or report of significant physical or sexual risky behavior with Impaired impulse control, judgment, or insight that significantly endangers self

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1. American Association of Community Psychiatrists. CALOCUS/CASII: Child and Adolescent Level of Care Utilization System. Child and Adolescent Version 20 [Internet] American Association of Community Psychiatrists. 2019 Jul Accessed at: <https://www.communitypsychiatry.org/keystone-programs/locus>. [accessed 2023 Sep 08]
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5. Shain B, Committee on Adolescence. Suicide and suicide attempts in adolescents. Pediatrics 2016;138(1):e20161420. DOI: 10.1542/peds.2016-1420. (Reaffirmed 2023 Jul)
6. The Assessment and Management of Suicide Risk Work Group. VA/DoD Clinical Practice Guideline for the Assessment and Management of Patients at Risk for Suicide. VA/DoD Evidence Based Practice [Internet] U.S. Department of Veteran Affairs and the Department of Defense. Version 2.0; 2019 Accessed at: <https://www.healthquality.va.gov/guidelines/>. [accessed 2023 May 15]

Footnotes

- A. Patients with persistent thoughts of suicide, homicide, or serious harm to self or another may need frequent monitoring for progression to planning or intention to act on their thoughts. Such monitoring can be safely conducted at an outpatient level of care if providers and supports are adequately available and the patient can reliably participate in the monitoring process.(4)

Delusions (adult)

- Delusions are fixed beliefs that are not amenable to change in light of conflicting evidence. Common themes include persecutory, grandiose, erotomanic, nihilistic, and somatic. Delusions are considered bizarre if they are clearly implausible, not understandable to peers of the same culture, and do not derive from ordinary life experiences. Thought withdrawal, thought insertion, and delusions of control are

examples of bizarre delusions.(1) Delusion severity may be described as(2)(3)(4):

- Minimal (subtle symptoms that may rarely bother the patient, and are not associated with pressure to act on beliefs or interference with daily functioning (may represent extreme end of normal range))
- Mild (symptoms may not be very bothersome to the patient, are only occasionally present, are associated with little pressure to act on beliefs, and contribute to **Mild** dysfunction in daily living for adult)
- Mild to moderate (symptoms may not be very bothersome to the patient, are established (eg, present up to half of each week), are associated with little pressure to act on beliefs, and contribute to **Mild to moderate** dysfunction in daily living for adult)
- Moderate (symptoms may be somewhat bothersome to the patient, are clearly established (eg, present more than half of each week, but not daily or near daily), are associated with pressure to act on beliefs, and contribute to **Moderate** dysfunction in daily living for adult)
- Moderately severe (symptoms may be bothersome to the patient, are associated with pressure to act on beliefs, are present more than half of each week (but not daily or near daily), and contribute to **Serious** dysfunction in daily living for adult, but are not all-consuming and usually can be contained at will)
- Severe (symptoms may be very bothersome to the patient, are present daily (or near daily), are associated with strong pressure to act on beliefs, and contribute to **Severe** dysfunction in daily living for adult (eg, symptoms may be all-consuming or cannot be contained at will, and often require close supervision))
- Extreme (symptoms may be highly disturbing to the patient, are present on an almost constant basis, are associated with intense pressure to act on beliefs, and contribute to **Severe** dysfunction in daily living for adult (condition usually requires close supervision))

References

1. Schizophrenia spectrum and other psychotic disorders. In: American Psychiatric Association, editor. Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders. DSM-5-TR ed. American Psychiatric Association; 2022:101-138.
2. Assessment measures. In: American Psychiatric Association, editor. Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders. DSM-5-TR ed. American Psychiatric Association; 2022:841-857.
3. Kay SR, Fiszbein A, Opler LA. The positive and negative syndrome scale (PANSS) for schizophrenia. Schizophrenia Bulletin 1987;13(2):261-276.
4. The PANSS Institute. [Internet] The PANSS Institute. Accessed at: <http://www.panss.org/>. Updated 2023 [accessed 2023 Sep 12]

Delusions (child or adolescent)

• Delusions are fixed beliefs that are not amenable to change in light of conflicting evidence. Common themes include persecutory, grandiose, erotomanic, nihilistic, and somatic. Delusions are considered bizarre if they are clearly implausible, not understandable to peers of the same culture, and do not derive from ordinary life experiences. Thought withdrawal, thought insertion, and delusions of control are examples of bizarre delusions. Instruments are available for assessing severity of symptoms in young people, including the instrument for positive and negative symptoms in severely disturbed children and adolescents (Kiddie-PANSS). Delusion severity may be described as(1)(2):

- Minimal (subtle symptoms that may rarely bother the patient, and are not associated with pressure to act on beliefs or interference with daily functioning (may represent extreme end of normal range))
- Mild (symptoms may not be very bothersome to the patient, are only occasionally present, are associated with little pressure to act on beliefs, and contribute to **Mild** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent)
- Mild to moderate (symptoms may not be very bothersome to the patient, are established (eg, present up to half of each week), are associated with little pressure to act on beliefs, and contribute to **Mild to moderate** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent)
- Moderate (symptoms may be somewhat bothersome to the patient, are clearly established (eg, present more than half of each week, but not daily or near daily), are associated with pressure to act on beliefs, and contribute to **Moderate** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent)
- Moderately severe (symptoms may be bothersome to the patient, are associated with pressure to act on beliefs, are present more than half of each week (but not daily or near daily), and contribute to **Serious** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent, but are not all-consuming and usually can be contained at will)
- Severe (symptoms may be very bothersome to the patient, are present daily (or near daily), are associated with strong pressure to act on beliefs, and contribute to **Severe** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent (eg, symptoms may be all-consuming or cannot be contained at will, and often require close supervision))
- Extreme (symptoms may be highly disturbing to the patient, are present on an almost constant basis, are associated with intense pressure to act on beliefs, and contribute to **Severe** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent (condition usually requires close supervision))

References

1. Schizophrenia spectrum and other psychotic disorders. In: American Psychiatric Association, editor. Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders. DSM-5-TR ed. American Psychiatric Association; 2022:101-138.
2. Fields JH, et al. Assessing positive and negative symptoms in children and adolescents. American Journal of Psychiatry 1994;151(2):249-53.

Depressive symptoms (adult)

• Multiple instruments are available to assess depression severity and may be used to measure changes in depressive symptoms throughout treatment. For example, the Patient Health Questionnaire-9 (PHQ-9) for adults, used in the primary care setting, assesses how frequently the patient experienced the following symptoms over the past 2 weeks(A)(1)(2)(3)(4)(5):

- Interest in activities
- Depressed mood/hopelessness
- Disturbed sleep
- Decreased energy
- Change in appetite
- Self-loathing
- Difficulty concentrating
- Psychomotor retardation
- Suicidal thoughts

References

1. Bukumiric Z, et al. Meta-analysis of the changes in correlations between depression instruments used in longitudinal studies. Journal of Affective Disorders 2016;190:733-743. DOI: 10.1016/j.jad.2015.10.054.
2. Kroenke K, Spitzer RL, Williams JB. The PHQ-9: validity of a brief depression severity measure. Journal of General Internal Medicine 2001;16(9):606-13.
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5. Riedel M, et al. Response and remission criteria in major depression--a validation of current practice. Journal of Psychiatric Research 2010;44(15):1063-8. DOI: 10.1016/j.jpsychires.2010.03.006.

Footnotes

- A. The diagnosis and severity of depressive disorders may be confirmed and documented by the use of standardized rating scales that reliably measure depressive symptoms in adults, including the Beck Depression Inventory (BDI), the Hamilton Depression Rating Scale (HDRS), the Patient Health Questionnaire-9 (PHQ-9) in the primary care setting, the Montgomery-Asberg Depression Rating Scale (MADRS), and the Geriatric Depression Scale (GDS) for older adults.(1)(2)(3) As an example, the PHQ-9 asks the patient to describe the frequency of 9 symptoms over the past 2 weeks on a scale of 0 to 3 (0 = not at all, 1 = several days, 2 = more than half the days, 3 = nearly every day), and depression severity is scored as follows: 0 to 4 none, 5 to 9 mild, 10 to 14 moderate, 15 to 19 moderately severe, and 20 to 27 severe.(4) In addition to screening, rating scales are often administered throughout treatment to measure changes in symptoms. An approximate 50% decrease in scores on the BDI, HDRS, PHQ-9, and/or MADRS has been found to be clinically significant when reassessing an individual for interval improvement.(2)(5)

Depressive symptoms (child or adolescent)

• Multiple instruments are available to assess depression severity and may be used to measure changes in depressive symptoms throughout treatment. For example, the Patient Health Questionnaire-9 (PHQ-9) modified for adolescents (PHQ-A), used in the primary care setting, assesses how frequently the patient experienced symptoms over the past 2 weeks. Of note, the PHQ-A has been validated for use with adolescents, but has not been validated for use with children younger than 11 years of age. Symptoms assessed include(A)(1)(2)(3)(4)(5)(6)(7)(8):

- Interest in activities
- Depressed mood/hopelessness
- Disturbed sleep
- Decreased energy
- Change in appetite
- Self-loathing
- Difficulty concentrating
- Psychomotor retardation

- Suicidal thoughts

References

1. US Preventive Services Task Force, et al. Screening for depression and suicide risk in children and adolescents: US Preventive Services Task Force recommendation statement. *Journal of the American Medical Association* 2022;328(15):1534-1542. DOI: 10.1001/jama.2022.16946. (Reaffirmed 2022 Oct)
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6. Kroenke K, Spitznagel RL, Williams JB. The PHQ-9: validity of a brief depression severity measure. *Journal of General Internal Medicine* 2001;16(9):606-13.
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8. Richardson LP, et al. Collaborative care for adolescents with depression in primary care: a randomized clinical trial. *Journal of the American Medical Association* 2014;312(8):809-16. DOI: 10.1001/jama.2014.9259.

Footnotes

- A. The diagnosis and severity of depressive disorders may be confirmed and documented by the use of standardized rating scales that reliably measure depressive symptoms in children and adolescents, including the Beck Depression Inventory (BDI), the Children's Depression Inventory (CDI), and the Patient Health Questionnaire-9 (PHQ-9) modified for adolescents (PHQ-A) in the primary care setting. (1)(2)(3) As an example, the PHQ-9 asks the patient to describe the frequency of 9 symptoms over the past 2 weeks on a scale of 0 to 3 (0 = not at all, 1 = several days, 2 = more than half the days, 3 = nearly every day), and depression severity is scored as follows: 0 to 4 none, 5 to 9 mild, 10 to 14 moderate, 15 to 19 moderately severe, and 20 to 27 severe. (4) In addition to screening, rating scales are often administered throughout treatment to measure changes in symptoms. An approximate 50% decrease in scores on the BDI and PHQ-A has been found to be clinically significant when reassessing an individual for interval improvement. (1)(5)(6)

Hallucinations (adult)

- Hallucinations are perceptions that occur without an external stimulus (eg, hearing, seeing, tasting, smelling, or feeling things that are not present). They may occur in any sensory modality, but auditory hallucinations are the most common in schizophrenia and related disorders. (1) Hallucination severity may be described as (2)(3)(4):
 - Minimal (subtle symptoms that may rarely bother the patient, and are not associated with pressure to act on beliefs or interference with daily functioning (may represent extreme end of normal range))
 - Mild (symptoms may not be very bothersome to the patient, are only occasionally present, are associated with little pressure to act on beliefs, and contribute to **Mild** dysfunction in daily living for adult)
 - Mild to moderate (symptoms may not be very bothersome to the patient, are established (eg, present up to half of each week), are associated with little pressure to act on beliefs, and contribute to **Mild to moderate** dysfunction in daily living for adult)
 - Moderate (symptoms may be somewhat bothersome to the patient, are clearly established (eg, present more than half of each week, but not daily or near daily), are associated with pressure to act on beliefs, and contribute to **Moderate** dysfunction in daily living for adult)
 - Moderately severe (symptoms may be bothersome to the patient, are associated with pressure to act on beliefs, are present more than half of each week (but not daily or near daily), and contribute to **Serious** dysfunction in daily living for adult, but are not all-consuming and usually can be contained at will)
 - Severe (symptoms may be very bothersome to the patient, are present daily (or near daily), are associated with strong pressure to act on beliefs, and contribute to **Severe** dysfunction in daily living for adult (eg, symptoms may be all-consuming or cannot be contained at will, and often require close supervision))
 - Extreme (symptoms may be highly disturbing to the patient, are present on an almost constant basis, are associated with intense pressure to act on beliefs, and contribute to **Severe** dysfunction in daily living for adult (condition usually requires close supervision))

References

1. Schizophrenia spectrum and other psychotic disorders. In: American Psychiatric Association, editor. *Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders*. DSM-5-TR ed. American Psychiatric Association; 2022:101-138.
2. Assessment measures. In: American Psychiatric Association, editor. *Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders*. DSM-5-TR ed. American Psychiatric Association; 2022:841-857.
3. Kay SR, Fiszbein A, Opler LA. The positive and negative syndrome scale (PANSS) for schizophrenia. *Schizophrenia Bulletin* 1987;13(2):261-276.
4. The PANSS Institute. [Internet] The PANSS Institute. Accessed at: <http://www.panss.org/>. Updated 2023 [accessed 2023 Sep 12]

Hallucinations (child or adolescent)

- Hallucinations are perceptions that occur without an external stimulus (eg, hearing, seeing, tasting, smelling, or feeling things that are not present). They may occur in any sensory modality, but auditory hallucinations are the most common in schizophrenia and related disorders. Instruments are available for assessing the severity of symptoms in young people, including the instrument for positive and negative symptoms in severely disturbed children and adolescents (Kiddie-PANSS). (1)(2)

References

1. Schizophrenia spectrum and other psychotic disorders. In: American Psychiatric Association, editor. *Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders*. DSM-5-TR ed. American Psychiatric Association; 2022:101-138.
2. Fields JH, et al. Assessing positive and negative symptoms in children and adolescents. *American Journal of Psychiatry* 1994;151(2):249-53.

Harm

- Harm to self or another is considered serious if it has a substantial likelihood of causing death, disability, or major disfigurement. (1)(2)(3)(4)(5)

References

1. American Association of Community Psychiatrists. Level of Care Utilization System for Psychiatric and Addiction Services (LOCUS). Adult version 20 [Internet] American Association of Community Psychiatrists. 2016 Dec Accessed at: <https://www.communitypsychiatry.org/keystone-programs/locus>. [accessed 2023 Sep 11]
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4. Child & Adolescent Service Intensity Instrument (CASII) User's Manual version 4.0. American Academy of Child and Adolescent Psychiatry 2014 Oct.
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Hyperactivity or inattention (adult)

- Hyperactivity refers to increased movement, impulsive actions, a decreased attention span, and easy distractibility. Inattention refers to easy distractibility and deficits in the ability to focus or stay on task. Determining severity includes the number of hyperactive or inattentive symptoms present, the frequency and duration of symptom presentation, and the impact that symptoms have on function and development. Levels of severity may be described as (1)(2):
 - Minimal (subtle symptoms that may rarely bother the patient, and are not associated with interference with daily functioning (may represent extreme end of normal range))
 - Mild (symptoms may not be very bothersome to the patient, are only occasionally present, and contribute to **Mild** dysfunction in daily living for adult)
 - Mild to moderate (symptoms may not be very bothersome to the patient, are established (eg, present up to half of each week), and contribute to **Mild to moderate** dysfunction in daily living for adult)
 - Moderate (symptoms may be somewhat bothersome to the patient, are clearly established (eg, present more than half of each week, but not daily or near daily), and contribute to **Moderate** dysfunction in daily living for adult)
 - Moderately severe (symptoms may be bothersome to the patient, are present more than half of each week (but not daily or near daily), and contribute to **Serious** dysfunction in daily living for adult, but are not all-consuming and usually can be contained at will)
 - Severe (symptoms may be very bothersome to the patient, are present daily (or near daily), and contribute to **Severe** dysfunction in daily living for adult (eg, symptoms may be all-consuming or cannot be contained at will, and often require close supervision))
 - Extreme (symptoms may be highly disturbing to the patient, are present on an almost constant basis, and contribute to **Severe** dysfunction in daily living for adult (condition usually requires close supervision))

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Hyperactivity or inattention (child or adolescent)

- Hyperactivity refers to increased movement, impulsive actions, a decreased attention span, and easy distractibility. Inattention refers to easy distractibility and deficits in the ability to focus or stay on task. Determining severity includes the number of hyperactive or inattentive symptoms present, the frequency and duration of symptom presentation, and the impact that symptoms have on function and development. Levels of severity may be described as(1):
 - Minimal (subtle symptoms that may rarely bother the patient, and are not associated with interference with daily functioning (may represent extreme end of normal range))
 - Mild (symptoms may not be very bothersome to the patient, are only occasionally present, and contribute to **Mild** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent)
 - Mild to moderate (symptoms may not be very bothersome to the patient, are established (eg, present up to half of each week), and contribute to **Mild to moderate** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent)
 - Moderate (symptoms may be somewhat bothersome to the patient, are clearly established (eg, present more than half of each week, but not daily or near daily), and contribute to **Moderate** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent)
 - Moderately severe (symptoms may be bothersome to the patient, are present more than half of each week (but not daily or near daily), and contribute to **Serious** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent, but are not all-consuming and usually can be contained at will)
 - Severe (symptoms may be very bothersome to the patient, are present daily (or near daily), and contribute to **Severe** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent (eg, symptoms may be all-consuming or cannot be contained at will, and often require close supervision))
 - Extreme (symptoms may be highly disturbing to the patient, are present on an almost constant basis, and contribute to **Severe** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent (condition usually requires close supervision))

References

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Imminent danger to others for adult

- Imminent danger to others for adult is present due to **1 or more** of the following(1)(2)(3):
 - Imminent risk for recurrence of attempt to seriously Harm another is present, as indicated by **ALL** of the following:
 - There has been a recent attempt to seriously Harm another.
 - There has not been Sufficient relief of factors that precipitated the attempt.
 - Current plan for homicide or serious Harm to another is present.
 - Command auditory hallucinations or paranoid delusions contributing to risk for homicide or serious Harm to another are present.
 - Patient has persistent thoughts of homicide or violent acts that likely could result in serious Harm to another that cannot be adequately monitored or treated at lower level of care, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following[A]:
 - Necessary behavioral health care (such as required provider or lower level of care) not available or insufficient
 - Patient support system inadequate
 - Patient characteristics, such as extremely Impaired impulse control, judgment, or insight; severe Mania (adult), severe unreliability, or extreme agitation with desperation
 - Ruminative flooding; uncontrollable and overwhelming negative thoughts
 - Indication or report of repeated behavior, including physical or sexual aggression that is clearly injurious to others with history, plan or intent, and extremely Impaired impulse control, judgment, or insight

References

1. American Association of Community Psychiatrists. Level of Care Utilization System for Psychiatric and Addiction Services (LOCUS). Adult version 20 [Internet] American Association of Community Psychiatrists. 2016 Dec Accessed at: <https://www.communitypsychiatry.org/keystone-programs/locus>. [accessed 2023 Sep 11]
2. APA Work Group on Psychiatric Evaluation. The American Psychiatric Association practice Guidelines for the Psychiatric Evaluation of Adults. 3rd edition [Internet] American Psychiatric Association. 2016 Accessed at: <https://psychiatryonline.org/>. [accessed 2023 Sep 21] DOI: 10.1176/appi.books.9780890426760.
3. The Assessment and Management of Suicide Risk Work Group. VA/DoD Clinical Practice Guideline for the Assessment and Management of Patients at Risk for Suicide. VA/DoD Evidence Based Practice [Internet] U.S. Department of Veteran Affairs and the Department of Defense. Version 2.0; 2019 Accessed at: <https://www.healthquality.va.gov/guidelines/>. [accessed 2023 May 15]

Footnotes

- A. Patients with persistent thoughts of suicide, homicide, or serious harm to self or another may need frequent monitoring for progression to planning or intention to act on their thoughts. Such monitoring can be safely conducted at an outpatient level of care if providers and supports are adequately available and the patient can reliably participate in the monitoring process.(2)

Imminent danger to others for child or adolescent

- Imminent danger to others for child or adolescent is present due to **1 or more** of the following(1)(2)(3)(4)(5)(6):
 - Imminent risk for recurrence of attempt to seriously Harm another is present, as indicated by **ALL** of the following:
 - There has been a recent attempt to seriously Harm another.
 - There has not been Sufficient relief of factors that precipitated the attempt.
 - Current plan for homicide or serious Harm to another is present.
 - Command auditory hallucinations or paranoid delusions contributing to risk for homicide or serious Harm to another are present.
 - Patient has persistent thoughts of homicide or violent acts that likely could result in serious Harm to another that cannot be adequately monitored or treated at lower level of care, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following[A]:
 - Necessary child or adolescent behavioral health care (such as required provider or lower level of care) not available or insufficient
 - Severe conflict in family environment or other inadequacy in patient support system
 - Patient characteristics, such as extremely Impaired impulse control, judgment, or insight; severe Mania (child or adolescent), severe unreliability, or extreme agitation with desperation
 - Ruminative flooding; uncontrollable and overwhelming negative thoughts
 - Indication or report of repeated behavior, including physical or sexual aggression that is clearly injurious to others with history, plan or intent, and extremely Impaired impulse control, judgment, or insight

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2. American Association of Community Psychiatrists. CALOCUS/CASII: Child and Adolescent Level of Care Utilization System. Child and Adolescent Version 20 [Internet] American Association of Community Psychiatrists. 2019 Jul Accessed at: <https://www.communitypsychiatry.org/keystone-programs/locus>. [accessed 2023 Sep 08]
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6. The Assessment and Management of Suicide Risk Work Group. VA/DoD Clinical Practice Guideline for the Assessment and Management of Patients at Risk for Suicide. VA/DoD Evidence Based Practice [Internet] U.S. Department of Veteran Affairs and the Department of Defense. Version 2.0; 2019 Accessed at: <https://www.healthquality.va.gov/guidelines/>. [accessed 2023 May 15]
7. Sewall CJR, Goldstein TR, Brent DA. Youth suicide. In: Dulcan MK, editor. Dulcan's Textbook of Child and Adolescent Psychiatry. 3rd ed. American Psychiatric Association Publishing; 2022:551-564.

Footnotes

- A. Patients with persistent thoughts of suicide, homicide, or serious harm to self or another may need frequent monitoring for progression to planning or intention to act on their thoughts. Such monitoring can be safely conducted at an outpatient level of care if providers and supports are adequately available and the patient can reliably participate in the monitoring process.(7)

Imminent danger to self for adult

- Imminent danger to self for adult is present due to **1 or more** of the following(1)(2)(3):
 - Imminent risk for recurrence of Suicide attempt or act of serious Harm to self is present, as indicated by **ALL** of the following:
 - There has been a recent Suicide attempt or deliberate act of serious Harm to self.
 - There has not been Sufficient relief of the factors that precipitated attempt or act.
 - Current plan for suicide or serious Harm to self is present.
 - Command auditory hallucinations or paranoid delusions contributing to risk for suicide or serious Harm to self are present.
 - Patient has persistent Thoughts of suicide or serious Harm to self that cannot be adequately monitored or treated at lower level of care, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following(A):
 - Necessary behavioral health care (such as required provider or lower level of care) not available or insufficient
 - Patient support system inadequate
 - Patient characteristics, such as extremely Impaired impulse control, judgment, or insight; severe Mania (adult), severe unreliability, or extreme agitation with desperation
 - Ruminative flooding; uncontrollable and overwhelming negative thoughts
 - Frantic hopelessness; fatalistic conviction that life will not improve, along with oppressive sense of entrapment and doom

References

- American Association of Community Psychiatrists. Level of Care Utilization System for Psychiatric and Addiction Services (LOCUS). Adult version 20 [Internet] American Association of Community Psychiatrists. 2016 Dec Accessed at: <https://www.communitypsychiatry.org/keystone-programs/locus>. [accessed 2023 Sep 11]
- APA Work Group on Psychiatric Evaluation. The American Psychiatric Association practice Guidelines for the Psychiatric Evaluation of Adults. 3rd edition [Internet] American Psychiatric Association. 2016 Accessed at: <https://psychiatryonline.org/>. [accessed 2023 Sep 21] DOI: 10.1176/appi.books.9780890426760.
- The Assessment and Management of Suicide Risk Work Group. VA/DoD Clinical Practice Guideline for the Assessment and Management of Patients at Risk for Suicide. VA/DoD Evidence Based Practice [Internet] U.S. Department of Veteran Affairs and the Department of Defense. Version 2.0; 2019 Accessed at: <https://www.healthquality.va.gov/guidelines/>. [accessed 2023 May 15]

Footnotes

- A. Patients with persistent thoughts of suicide, homicide, or serious harm to self or another may need frequent monitoring for progression to planning or intention to act on their thoughts. Such monitoring can be safely conducted at an outpatient level of care if providers and supports are adequately available and the patient can reliably participate in the monitoring process.(2)

Imminent danger to self for child or adolescent

- Imminent danger to self for child or adolescent is present due to **1 or more** of the following(1)(2)(3)(4)(5)(6):
 - Imminent risk for recurrence of Suicide attempt or act of serious Harm to self is present, as indicated by **ALL** of the following:
 - There has been a recent Suicide attempt or deliberate act of serious Harm to self.
 - There has not been Sufficient relief of the factors that precipitated attempt or act.
 - Current plan for suicide or serious Harm to self is present.
 - Command auditory hallucinations or paranoid delusions contributing to risk for suicide or serious Harm to self are present.
 - Patient has persistent Thoughts of suicide or serious Harm to self that cannot be adequately monitored or treated at lower level of care, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following(A):
 - Necessary child or adolescent behavioral health care (such as required provider or lower level of care) not available or insufficient
 - Severe conflict in family environment or other inadequacy in patient support system
 - Patient characteristics, such as extremely Impaired impulse control, judgment, or insight; severe Mania (child or adolescent), severe unreliability, or extreme agitation with desperation
 - Ruminative flooding; uncontrollable and overwhelming negative thoughts
 - Frantic hopelessness; fatalistic conviction that life will not improve, along with oppressive sense of entrapment and doom

References

- American Association of Community Psychiatrists. CALOCUS/CASII: Child and Adolescent Level of Care Utilization System. Child and Adolescent Version 20 [Internet] American Association of Community Psychiatrists. 2019 Jul Accessed at: <https://www.communitypsychiatry.org/keystone-programs/locus>. [accessed 2023 Sep 08]
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- The Assessment and Management of Suicide Risk Work Group. VA/DoD Clinical Practice Guideline for the Assessment and Management of Patients at Risk for Suicide. VA/DoD Evidence Based Practice [Internet] U.S. Department of Veteran Affairs and the Department of Defense. Version 2.0; 2019 Accessed at: <https://www.healthquality.va.gov/guidelines/>. [accessed 2023 May 15]
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Footnotes

- A. Patients with persistent thoughts of suicide, homicide, or serious harm to self or another may need frequent monitoring for progression to planning or intention to act on their thoughts. Such monitoring can be safely conducted at an outpatient level of care if providers and supports are adequately available and the patient can reliably participate in the monitoring process.(4)

Impaired impulse control, judgment, or insight

- Impaired impulse control describes a lack of control or ability to regulate actions related to inner urges. Impaired judgment and insight may include a lack of recognition of current or past symptoms, denial of need for treatment, or lack of recognition of consequences of actions. Levels of severity may be described as(1)(2)(3):
 - Minimal (subtle symptoms that may rarely bother the patient and are not associated with interference with daily functioning (may represent extreme end of normal range))
 - Mild (symptoms may not be very bothersome to the patient, are only occasionally present, and contribute to **Mild** dysfunction in daily living for adult or **Mild** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent)
 - Mild to moderate (symptoms may not be very bothersome to the patient, are established (eg, present up to half of each week), and contribute to **Mild to moderate** dysfunction in daily living for adult or **Mild to moderate** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent)
 - Moderate (symptoms may be somewhat bothersome to the patient, are clearly established (eg, present more than half of each week, but not daily or near daily), and contribute to **Moderate** dysfunction in daily living for adult or **Moderate** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent)
 - Moderately severe (symptoms may be bothersome to the patient, are present more than half of each week (but not daily or near daily), and contribute to **Serious** dysfunction in daily living for adult or **Serious** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent but are not all-consuming and usually can be contained at will)
 - Severe (symptoms may be very bothersome to the patient, are present daily (or near daily), and contribute to **Severe** dysfunction in daily living for adult or **Severe** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent (eg, symptoms may be all-consuming or cannot be contained at will, and often require close supervision))
 - Extreme (symptoms may be highly disturbing to the patient, are present on an almost constant basis, and contribute to **Severe** dysfunction in daily living for adult or **Severe** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent (condition usually requires close supervision))

References

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- Disruptive, impulse-control, and conduct disorders. In: American Psychiatric Association, editor. Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders. DSM-5-TR ed. American Psychiatric Association; 2022:521-541.

Mania (adult)

- Mania symptoms may include elated/irritable mood, grandiosity, decreased need for sleep (eg, feeling rested after only a few hours of sleep), hyperverbal or rapid pressured speech, flight of ideas, racing thoughts, distractibility (ie, attention too easily drawn to unimportant or irrelevant external stimuli), increase in goal-directed activity (either socially, at work, or at school), hypersexuality, excessive energy, psychomotor agitation, or excessive involvement in pleasurable activities that have a high potential for negative consequences (eg, engaging in unrestrained buying sprees, sexual indiscretions, or foolish business investments). Symptoms do not have an alternative explanation (eg, intoxication, delirium, or other medical condition). Symptom severity may be described as(1)(2)(3)(4)(5)(6):
 - Mild (periods of somewhat elevated, expansive, or irritable mood, or other manic symptoms that are occasionally present)
 - Mild to moderate (periods of somewhat elevated, expansive, or irritable mood, or other manic symptoms that are present up to half the days of each week)
 - Moderate (periods of extensively elevated, expansive, or irritable mood or restlessness, or other manic symptoms that are present more than half the days of each week)
 - Moderately severe (frequent, but not daily, periods of extensively elevated, expansive, or irritable mood or restlessness, or other manic symptoms)

- Severe (daily periods of extensively elevated, expansive, or irritable mood or restlessness, or other manic symptoms)

References

1. Assessment measures. In: American Psychiatric Association, editor. Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders. DSM-5-TR ed. American Psychiatric Association; 2022:841-857.
2. Altman EG, Hedecker D, Peterson JL, Davis JM. The Altman self-rating mania scale. *Biological Psychiatry* 1997;42(10):948-55. DOI: 10.1016/S0006-3223(96)00548-3.
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Mania (child or adolescent)

- Mania symptoms may include elated/irritable mood, grandiosity, decreased need for sleep (eg, feeling rested after only a few hours of sleep), hyperverbal or rapid pressured speech, flight of ideas, racing thoughts, distractibility (ie, attention too easily drawn to unimportant or irrelevant external stimuli), increase in goal-directed activity (eg, socially or at school), hypersexuality, excessive energy, psychomotor agitation, or excessive involvement in pleasurable activities that have a high potential for negative consequences. Symptoms do not have an alternative explanation (eg, intoxication, delirium, or other medical condition).(1)(2)

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Mild dysfunction in daily living for adult

- **Mild** dysfunction in daily living for adult is present, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following(1)(2)(3)(4)(5)(6):
 - Some deterioration in interpersonal interactions (eg, increased conflict), but able to maintain some meaningful relationships
 - Some recent minor disruptions in self-care
 - Minor but consistent disruptions in social role functioning and meeting obligations, but still able to maintain these roles
 - Self-neglect with at least some minor limitation in ability to provide for basic needs (by self or others) in maintenance care
 - Other evidence of mild dysfunction

References

1. American Association of Community Psychiatrists. Level of Care Utilization System for Psychiatric and Addiction Services (LOCUS). Adult version 20 [Internet] American Association of Community Psychiatrists. 2016 Dec Accessed at: <https://www.communitypsychiatry.org/keystone-programs/locus>. [accessed 2023 Sep 11]
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6. Sheehan Disability Scale (SDS). [Internet] Psychiatry & Behavioral Health Learning Network. 2019 Jan 28 Accessed at: <https://www.psychcongress.com/saundras-corner/scales-screeners/disability-scales/sheehan-disability-scale-sds>. [created 1983; accessed 2023 Aug 11]

Mild dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent

- **Mild** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent is present, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following(1)(2)(3)(4)(5)(6)(7):
 - Minor deterioration or episodic failure in relationships with peers, family, or adults (eg, defiance, lying, provocative behavior)
 - Self-care sporadically below usual or expected standards
 - Impairments in function characterized by ability to show improvements following episodes of deterioration
 - Diminished ability to assess consequences of own actions (eg, acts of severe property damage) that therapeutic intervention can remediate
 - Self-neglect with at least some minor limitation in ability to provide for basic needs (by self or others) in maintenance care
 - Other evidence of mild dysfunction

References

1. American Association of Community Psychiatrists. CALOCUS/CASII: Child and Adolescent Level of Care Utilization System. Child and Adolescent Version 20 [Internet] American Association of Community Psychiatrists. 2019 Jul Accessed at: <https://www.communitypsychiatry.org/keystone-programs/locus>. [accessed 2023 Sep 08]
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6. Lundh A, Kowalski J, Sundberg CJ, Gumpert C, Landen M. Children's Global Assessment Scale (CGAS) in a naturalistic clinical setting: Inter-rater reliability and comparison with expert ratings. *Psychiatry Research* 2010;177(1-2):206-10. DOI: 10.1016/j.psychres.2010.02.006.
7. Early Childhood Service Intensity Instrument (ECSII) for Infants, Toddlers, and Preschool-aged Children Ages 0-5 version 1. American Academy of Child and Adolescent Psychiatry 2009 Sep.

Mild to moderate dysfunction in daily living for adult

- **Mild to moderate** dysfunction in daily living for adult is present, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following(1)(2)(3)(4)(5)(6):
 - Some recent deterioration in interpersonal interactions (eg, conflicted, withdrawn), but maintains control of impulsive or abusive behaviors and maintains some meaningful relationships
 - Some recent disruptions in self-care below usual or expected standards
 - Disturbance in vegetative status (eg, eating, sleeping habits) that does not pose serious threat to health
 - Some deterioration in social role functioning and meeting obligations (eg, avoiding responsibilities on some occasions), but still can maintain roles overall
 - Other evidence of mild to moderate dysfunction

References

1. American Association of Community Psychiatrists. Level of Care Utilization System for Psychiatric and Addiction Services (LOCUS). Adult version 20 [Internet] American Association of Community Psychiatrists. 2016 Dec Accessed at: <https://www.communitypsychiatry.org/keystone-programs/locus>. [accessed 2023 Sep 11]
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6. Sheehan Disability Scale (SDS). [Internet] Psychiatry & Behavioral Health Learning Network. 2019 Jan 28 Accessed at: <https://www.psychcongress.com/saundras-corner/scales-screeners/disability-scales/sheehan-disability-scale-sds>. [created 1983; accessed 2023 Aug 11]

Mild to moderate dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent

- **Mild to moderate** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent is present, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following(1)(2)(3)(4)(5)(6)(7):
 - Some difficulty in relationships with peers, family, or adults (eg, defiance, lying), but without physical aggression
 - Self-care sometimes below usual or expected standards
 - Disturbance in vegetative status (eg, eating, sleeping habits) that does not pose serious threat to health
 - Deteriorating school behavior such that disruption in school is threatened (eg, threat of expulsion)

- Diminished ability to assess consequences of own actions (eg, acts of severe property damage) that therapeutic intervention can remediate
- Other evidence of mild to moderate dysfunction

References

1. American Association of Community Psychiatrists. CALOCUS/CASII: Child and Adolescent Level of Care Utilization System. Child and Adolescent Version 20 [Internet] American Association of Community Psychiatrists. 2019 Jul Accessed at: <https://www.communitypsychiatry.org/keystone-programs/locus>. [accessed 2023 Sep 08]
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3. Child & Adolescent Service Intensity Instrument (CASII) User's Manual version 4.0. American Academy of Child and Adolescent Psychiatry 2014 Oct.
4. International Classification of Functioning, Disability and Health. Children & Youth Version [Internet] World Health Organization. 2007 Accessed at: <https://www.who.int/classifications/icf/en/>. [accessed 2022 Apr 28]
5. Shaffer D, et al. A children's global assessment scale (CGAS). Archives of General Psychiatry 1983;40(11):1228-31.
6. Lundh A, Kowalski J, Sundberg CJ, Gumpert C, Landen M. Children's Global Assessment Scale (CGAS) in a naturalistic clinical setting: Inter-rater reliability and comparison with expert ratings. Psychiatry Research 2010;177(1-2):206-10. DOI: 10.1016/j.psychres.2010.02.006.
7. Early Childhood Service Intensity Instrument (ECSII) for Infants, Toddlers, and Preschool-aged Children Ages 0-5 version 1. American Academy of Child and Adolescent Psychiatry 2009 Sep.

Moderate dysfunction in daily living for adult

- **Moderate** dysfunction in daily living for adult is present, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following(1)(2)(3)(4)(5)(6):
 - Recent conflicted, withdrawn, or troubled relationships, but maintains control of impulsive, aggressive, or abusive behaviors
 - Self-care frequently below usual or expected standards
 - Significant disturbance in vegetative status (eg, eating, sleeping habits), but not posing serious threat to health
 - Significant deterioration in ability to fulfill responsibilities (eg, work, commitments to significant others), including neglect or avoidance of these responsibilities on some occasions
 - Ongoing and variably severe deficits in interpersonal relationships and ability to engage socially in constructive manner
 - Other evidence of moderate dysfunction

References

1. American Association of Community Psychiatrists. Level of Care Utilization System for Psychiatric and Addiction Services (LOCUS). Adult version 20 [Internet] American Association of Community Psychiatrists. 2016 Dec Accessed at: <https://www.communitypsychiatry.org/keystone-programs/locus>. [accessed 2023 Sep 11]
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5. Sheehan DV, Harnett-Sheehan K, Raj BA. The measurement of disability. International Clinical Psychopharmacology 1996;11 Suppl 3:89-95.
6. Sheehan Disability Scale (SDS). [Internet] Psychiatry & Behavioral Health Learning Network. 2019 Jan 28 Accessed at: <https://www.psychcongress.com/saundras-corner/scales-screeners/disability-scales/sheehan-disability-scale-sds>. [created 1983; accessed 2023 Aug 11]

Moderate dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent

- **Moderate** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent is present, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following(1)(2)(3)(4)(5)(6)(7):
 - Troubled relationships with peers, family, or adults (eg, conflicted, withdrawn), but without physical aggression
 - Self-care frequently below usual or expected standards
 - Significant disturbance in vegetative status (eg, eating, sleeping habits), but not posing serious threat to health
 - Deteriorated school behavior such that disruption in school has occurred (eg, suspension, expulsion), and child is at risk for placement in alternative school setting or repeating grade
 - Diminished ability to assess consequences of own actions (eg, acts of severe property damage)
 - Other evidence of moderate dysfunction

References

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Negative symptoms (adult)

- Negative symptoms represent thoughts, feelings, or behaviors that normally would be present, but are absent or diminished in relation to a psychiatric disorder. They may include apathy, anhedonia, poverty of speech, motor behavior that is diminished or signs or symptoms of psychomotor retardation.(1)(2)(3) Levels of severity may be described as:
 - Minimal (subtle symptoms that may rarely bother the patient, and are not associated with interference with daily functioning (may represent extreme end of normal range))
 - Mild (symptoms may not be very bothersome to the patient, are only occasionally present, and contribute to **Mild** dysfunction in daily living for adult)
 - Mild to moderate (symptoms may not be very bothersome to the patient, are established (eg, present up to half of each week), and contribute to **Mild to moderate** dysfunction in daily living for adult)
 - Moderate (symptoms may be somewhat bothersome to the patient, are clearly established (eg, present more than half of each week, but not daily or near daily), and contribute to **Moderate** dysfunction in daily living for adult)
 - Moderately severe (symptoms may be bothersome to the patient, are present more than half of each week (but not daily or near daily), and contribute to **Serious** dysfunction in daily living for adult, but are not all-consuming and usually can be contained at will)
 - Severe (symptoms may be very bothersome to the patient, are present daily (or near daily), and contribute to **Severe** dysfunction in daily living for adult (eg, symptoms may be all-consuming or cannot be contained at will, and often require close supervision))
 - Extreme (symptoms may be highly disturbing to the patient, are present on an almost constant basis, and contribute to **Severe** dysfunction in daily living for adult (condition usually requires close supervision))

References

1. Kay SR, Fiszbein A, Opler LA. The positive and negative syndrome scale (PANSS) for schizophrenia. Schizophrenia Bulletin 1987;13(2):261-276.
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Negative symptoms (child or adolescent)

- Negative symptoms represent thoughts, feelings, or behaviors that normally would be present, but are absent or diminished in relation to a psychiatric disorder. They may include apathy, anhedonia, poverty of speech, motor behavior that is diminished or signs or symptoms of psychomotor retardation. Instruments are available for assessing severity of symptoms in young people, including the instrument for positive and negative symptoms in severely disturbed children and adolescents (Kiddie-PANSS).(1)(2) Levels of severity may be described as:
 - Minimal (subtle symptoms that may rarely bother the patient, and are not associated with interference with daily functioning (may represent extreme end of normal range))
 - Mild (symptoms may not be very bothersome to the patient, are only occasionally present, and contribute to **Mild** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent)
 - Mild to moderate (symptoms may not be very bothersome to the patient, are established (eg, present up to half of each week), and contribute to **Mild to moderate** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent)
 - Moderate (symptoms may be somewhat bothersome to the patient, are clearly established (eg, present more than half of each week, but not daily or near daily), and contribute to **Moderate** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent)

- Moderately severe (symptoms may be bothersome to the patient, are present more than half of each week (but not daily or near daily), and contribute to **Serious** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent, but are not all-consuming and usually can be contained at will)
- Severe (symptoms may be very bothersome to the patient, are present daily (or near daily), and contribute to **Severe** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent (eg, symptoms may be all-consuming or cannot be contained at will, and often require close supervision))
- Extreme (symptoms may be highly disturbing to the patient, are present on an almost constant basis, and contribute to **Severe** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent (condition usually requires close supervision))

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No current plan

- Determining that no current plan exists for suicide, homicide, or serious harm to self or another involves clinical judgment regarding multiple factors. Lower risk may be indicated when **ALL** of the following are met(1)(2):
 - No evidence of identification and/or availability of severe or lethal method (eg, using a gun)
 - No evidence of preparatory acts (eg, writing suicide note)
 - No intention that an act that will have severe or fatal outcome (ie, no evidence of plan for where and when an action will be taken)

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Obsessions or compulsions (adult)

- Obsessions are recurrent and persistent thoughts, urges, or images that are intrusive and unwanted, which often cause marked anxiety or distress, and are associated with attempts to ignore, suppress, or neutralize these experiences.(1)(2) Compulsions are repetitive behaviors that the individual feels driven to perform in response to an obsession or according to rules that must be applied rigidly; the behaviors or mental acts are aimed at preventing or reducing anxiety or distress, or preventing some dreaded event or situation, but are not connected in a realistic way with what they are designed to neutralize or prevent (or are clearly excessive).(1)(2)

References

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2. Goodman WK, et al. The Yale-Brown Obsessive Compulsive Scale. I. Development, use, and reliability. Archives of General Psychiatry 1989;46(11):1006-11.

Obsessions or compulsions (child or adolescent)

- Obsessions are recurrent and persistent thoughts, urges, or images that are intrusive and unwanted, which often cause marked anxiety or distress, and are associated with attempts to ignore, suppress, or neutralize these experiences.(1)(2) Compulsions are repetitive behaviors that the individual feels driven to perform in response to an obsession or according to rules that must be applied rigidly; the behaviors or mental acts are aimed at preventing or reducing anxiety or distress, or preventing some dreaded event or situation, but are not connected in a realistic way with what they are designed to neutralize or prevent (or are clearly excessive). Young children may not be able to articulate the aims of these behaviors or mental acts.(1)(2)(3)

References

1. Obsessive-compulsive and related disorders. In: American Psychiatric Association, editor. Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders. DSM-5-TR ed. American Psychiatric Association; 2022:263-294.
2. Goodman WK, et al. The Yale-Brown Obsessive Compulsive Scale. I. Development, use, and reliability. Archives of General Psychiatry 1989;46(11):1006-11.
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Other emotional or behavioral disturbance

- Emotional or behavioral disturbances impacting symptoms or function, including **1 or more** of the following^{[A](3)(4)(5)}:
 - Externalizing symptoms (eg, angry outbursts, physical or verbal aggression, oppositional defiant traits, agitation, anxiety, or other disruptive behaviors)
 - Internalizing symptoms (eg, sulking, rumination, anhedonia, dysphoria, apathy)
 - Evidence of severely diminished ability to assess consequences of own actions (eg, acts of severe property damage)
 - High levels of family conflict or interpersonal conflict
 - Escalating relapse behaviors
 - Other emotional or behavioral disturbance relevant to clinical presentation

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Footnotes

- A. Symptoms may be circumscribed (eg, attention-seeking behaviors) or may be seen in the context of one or more major psychiatric disorders, including depression; anxiety disorders; obsessive-compulsive disorder; posttraumatic stress disorder; eating disorders; attention-deficit hyperactivity disorders; bipolar disorders; schizophrenia; personality disorders; autism spectrum disorder and other disruptive, impulse-control, and conduct disorders.(1)(2)(3)

Positive symptoms (adult)

- Positive symptoms are feelings, thoughts, perceptions, or behaviors that usually are not present. They may include hallucinations, delusions, or other symptoms that are abnormal or bizarre. Levels of severity may be described as(1)(2)(3)(4):
 - Minimal (subtle symptoms that may rarely bother the patient, and are not associated with pressure to act on beliefs or interference with daily functioning (may represent extreme end of normal range))
 - Mild (symptoms may not be very bothersome to the patient, are only occasionally present, are associated with little pressure to act on beliefs, and contribute to **Mild** dysfunction in daily living for adult)
 - Mild to moderate (symptoms may not be very bothersome to the patient, are established (eg, present up to half of each week), are associated with little pressure to act on beliefs, and contribute to **Mild to moderate** dysfunction in daily living for adult)
 - Moderate (symptoms may be somewhat bothersome to the patient, are clearly established (eg, present more than half of each week, but not daily or near daily), are associated with pressure to act on beliefs, and contribute to **Moderate** dysfunction in daily living for adult)

- Moderately severe (symptoms may be bothersome to the patient, are associated with pressure to act on beliefs, are present more than half of each week (but not daily or near daily), and contribute to **Serious** dysfunction in daily living for adult, but are not all-consuming and usually can be contained at will)
- Severe (symptoms may be very bothersome to the patient, are present daily (or near daily), are associated with strong pressure to act on beliefs, and contribute to **Severe** dysfunction in daily living for adult (eg, symptoms may be all-consuming or cannot be contained at will, and often require close supervision))
- Extreme (symptoms may be highly disturbing to the patient, are present on an almost constant basis, are associated with intense pressure to act on beliefs, and contribute to **Severe** dysfunction in daily living for adult (condition usually requires close supervision))

References

1. Kay SR, Fiszbein A, Opler LA. The positive and negative syndrome scale (PANSS) for schizophrenia. *Schizophrenia Bulletin* 1987;13(2):261-276.
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3. Assessment measures. In: American Psychiatric Association, editor. *Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders*. DSM-5-TR ed. American Psychiatric Association; 2022:841-857.
4. Schizophrenia spectrum and other psychotic disorders. In: American Psychiatric Association, editor. *Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders*. DSM-5-TR ed. American Psychiatric Association; 2022:101-138.

Positive symptoms (child or adolescent)

- Positive symptoms are feelings, thoughts, perceptions, or behaviors that usually are not present. They may include hallucinations, delusions, or other symptoms that are abnormal or bizarre. Instruments are available for assessing severity of symptoms in young people, including the instrument for positive and negative symptoms in children and adolescents (Kiddie-PANSS).(1)(2) Levels of severity may be described as:
 - Minimal (subtle symptoms that may rarely bother the patient, and are not associated with pressure to act on beliefs or interference with daily functioning (may represent extreme end of normal range))
 - Mild (symptoms may not be very bothersome to the patient, are only occasionally present, are associated with little pressure to act on beliefs, and contribute to **Mild** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent)
 - Mild to moderate (symptoms may not be very bothersome to the patient, are established (eg, present up to half of each week), are associated with little pressure to act on beliefs, and contribute to **Mild to moderate** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent)
 - Moderate (symptoms may be somewhat bothersome to the patient, are clearly established (eg, present more than half of each week, but not daily or near daily), are associated with pressure to act on beliefs, and contribute to **Moderate** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent)
 - Moderately severe (symptoms may be bothersome to the patient, are associated with pressure to act on beliefs, are present more than half of each week (but not daily or near daily), and contribute to **Serious** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent, but are not all-consuming and usually can be contained at will)
 - Severe (symptoms may be very bothersome to the patient, are present daily (or near daily), are associated with strong pressure to act on beliefs, and contribute to **Severe** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent (eg, symptoms may be all-consuming or cannot be contained at will, and often require close supervision))
 - Extreme (symptoms may be highly disturbing to the patient, are present on an almost constant basis, are associated with intense pressure to act on beliefs, and contribute to **Severe** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent (condition usually requires close supervision))

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1. Schizophrenia spectrum and other psychotic disorders. In: American Psychiatric Association, editor. *Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders*. DSM-5-TR ed. American Psychiatric Association; 2022:101-138.
2. Fields JH, et al. Assessing positive and negative symptoms in children and adolescents. *American Journal of Psychiatry* 1994;151(2):249-53.

Psychiatric symptoms (adult)

- Psychiatric symptoms, including **1 or more** of the following(1):
 - Hallucinations (adult), Delusions (adult), or other Positive symptoms (adult)
 - Negative symptoms (adult), including social or emotional withdrawal or lack of self-initiated behavior or movement
 - Mania (adult)
 - Depressive symptoms (adult)
 - Anxiety (adult)
 - Hyperactivity or inattention (adult)
 - Obsessions or compulsions (adult)
 - Personality disorders/maladaptive personality traits
 - Other psychiatric symptoms related to underlying psychiatric disorder or underlying comorbid condition having a negative impact on primary psychiatric disorder

References

1. Matorin AA, Shah AA, Ruiz P. Clinical manifestations of psychiatric disorders. In: Sadock BJ, Sadock VA, Ruiz P, editors. *Kaplan and Sadock's Comprehensive Textbook of Psychiatry*. 10th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Lippincott Williams & Wilkins; 2017:1114-1150.

Psychiatric symptoms (child or adolescent)

- Psychiatric symptoms, including **1 or more** of the following(1):
 - Hallucinations (child or adolescent), Delusions (child or adolescent), or other Positive symptoms (child or adolescent)
 - Negative symptoms (child or adolescent), including social or emotional withdrawal or lack of self-initiated behavior or movement
 - Mania (child or adolescent)
 - Depressive symptoms (child or adolescent)
 - Anxiety (child or adolescent)
 - Hyperactivity or inattention (child or adolescent)
 - Obsessions or compulsions (child or adolescent)
 - Personality disorders/maladaptive personality traits
 - Other psychiatric symptoms related to underlying psychiatric disorder or underlying comorbid condition having a negative impact on primary psychiatric disorder

References

1. Matorin AA, Shah AA, Ruiz P. Clinical manifestations of psychiatric disorders. In: Sadock BJ, Sadock VA, Ruiz P, editors. *Kaplan and Sadock's Comprehensive Textbook of Psychiatry*. 10th ed. Philadelphia, PA: Lippincott Williams & Wilkins; 2017:1114-1150.

Psychiatric, behavioral, or other comorbid conditions for adult

- Psychiatric, behavioral, or other comorbid conditions for adult are appropriate for management at proposed level of care, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following[A]:
 - Psychiatric symptoms (adult)
 - Comorbid biomedical or developmental condition[B][C]
 - Comorbid substance use disorder[D][E]
 - Cognitive or memory impairment[F]
 - Impaired impulse control, judgment, or insight
 - Other emotional or behavioral disturbance

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Footnotes

- A. Determination of severity may be based on symptom severity alone (including intensity or frequency of symptoms and the extent to which they interfere with functioning), or may be due to other factors (eg, comorbid medical illness, developmental condition, cognitive impairment, substance use disorder, or other factors that contribute to destabilization or decreased ability to cope with the underlying behavioral health disorder). If the comorbidity affects the level of care appropriate to meet the patient's behavioral health needs, the manner in which it impacts the behavioral health condition (and how the comorbidity will be managed/treated at the proposed level of care) should be documented in order to optimize comprehensive patient care. Assessment for comorbid conditions should take place at admission evaluation, and any identified conditions should be manageable/treatable by the program (either directly or through alternative arrangements). Co-occurring mental health and substance use conditions and co-occurring medical and behavioral health conditions are considered an expectation, not an exception, in all programs at all psychiatric and addiction service levels of care. Integrated care, with recovery-oriented and "co-occurring capable" services, is increasingly expected to be included in the design of programs at all levels of care and in all settings. In programs without integrated care, comorbidities that require more active management/treatment or that currently distract the patient from treatment or have been associated with challenges in treatment follow-through in the past should prompt consideration of a program designed to provide treatment for both disorders (eg, a dual-diagnosis program).(1)(2)(3)(4)(5)(6)(7)(8)
- B. A significant comorbid biomedical or developmental condition has the potential to prolong the course of illness, or necessitate admission to a higher level of care or closer monitoring of patients requiring psychiatric care.(1)(3)(4)(5)(9)
- C. Assessment and treatment of co-occurring medical and/or developmental conditions through services and treatment settings capable of rendering integrated care is recommended.(1)(2)(3)(4)(5)(10) A "whole person care" approach that coordinates care across physical health, behavioral health, and social service sectors may bridge the gap of physical and mental health.(11)(12)(13)(14) The level that comorbid medical and/or developmental conditions are present may be described on a continuum (none/absent, low, moderate, and severe) and may impact determination of the appropriate level of care for treatment (ie, admission to a higher level of care).(1)(3)(4)(5)(15)
- D. A significant comorbid substance use disorder (either reflecting comorbidity in a patient whose primary diagnosis is a psychiatric disorder, such as an affective disorder, or is present in a patient with a polysubstance use disorder) has the potential to impact the appropriate level of care in which the underlying condition is managed, or require consideration of a program with structures in place to treat multiple conditions, such as a dual-diagnosis program. The risk for problems with substance use is increased with the presence of many types of behavioral disturbance (eg, impulse control disorders, or self-medication of depression or anxiety symptoms). The severity of the substance use disorder as it relates to the underlying psychiatric condition includes the frequency and chronicity of use, ability to control use, intensity of other symptoms (eg, cravings, withdrawal), or other negative impact on the underlying condition.(1)(3)(4)(5)(7)(8)
- E. Evaluation/assessment and treatment of co-occurring substance use disorders through services and treatment settings capable of rendering integrated care is recommended.(1)(2)(3)(4)(5) A "whole person care" approach that coordinates care across physical health, behavioral health, and social service sectors may bridge the gap of physical and mental health.(11)(12)(13)(14) The level that comorbid substance use disorders contribute to the primary presenting condition may be described on a continuum (none/absent, low, moderate, and severe) and may impact determination of the appropriate level of care for treatment (ie, admission to a higher level of care or specialty dual-diagnosis program).(1)(3)(4)(5)(15)
- F. Intake and assessment should include a mental status examination and memory assessment. If cognitive impairments are identified, they may require modifying the intensity or pace of planned interventions to allow the patient to participate in the program, or using an enhanced program designed to address co-occurring cognitive disorders.(8)(16)(17)(18)(19)(20)

Psychiatric, behavioral, or other comorbid conditions for child or adolescent

- Psychiatric, behavioral, or other comorbid conditions for child or adolescent are appropriate for management at proposed level of care, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following^[A]:
 - Psychiatric symptoms (child or adolescent)
 - Comorbid biomedical or developmental condition^[B]^[C]
 - Comorbid substance use disorder^[D]^[E]
 - Cognitive or memory impairment^[F]
 - Impaired impulse control, judgment, or insight
 - Other emotional or behavioral disturbance

References

1. American Association of Community Psychiatrists. Level of Care Utilization System for Psychiatric and Addiction Services (LOCUS). Adult version 20 [Internet] American Association of Community Psychiatrists. 2016 Dec Accessed at: <https://www.communitypsychiatry.org/keystone-programs/locus>. [accessed 2023 Sep 11]
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Footnotes

- A. Determination of severity may be based on symptom severity alone (including intensity or frequency of symptoms and the extent to which they interfere with functioning), or may be due to other factors (eg, comorbid medical illness, developmental condition, cognitive impairment, substance use disorder, or other factors that contribute to destabilization or decreased ability to cope with the underlying behavioral health disorder). If the comorbidity affects the level of care appropriate to meet the patient's behavioral health needs, the manner in which it impacts the behavioral health condition (and how the comorbidity will be managed/treated at the proposed level of care) should be documented in order to optimize comprehensive patient care. Assessment for comorbid conditions should take place at admission evaluation, and any identified conditions should be manageable/treatable by the program (either directly or through alternative arrangements). Co-occurring mental health and substance use conditions and co-occurring medical and behavioral health conditions are considered an expectation, not an exception, in all programs at all psychiatric and addiction service levels of care. Integrated care, with recovery-oriented and "co-occurring capable" services, is increasingly expected to be included in the design of programs at all levels of care and in all settings. In programs without integrated care, comorbidities that require more active management/treatment or that currently distract the patient from treatment or have been associated with challenges in treatment follow-through in the past should prompt consideration of a program designed to provide treatment for both disorders (eg, a dual-diagnosis program).(1)(2)(3)(4)(5)(6)(7)(8)
- B. A significant comorbid biomedical or developmental condition has the potential to prolong the course of illness, or necessitate admission to a higher level of care or closer monitoring of patients requiring psychiatric care.(1)(3)(4)(5)(9)
- C. Assessment and treatment of co-occurring medical and/or developmental conditions through services and treatment settings capable of rendering integrated care is recommended.(1)(2)(3)(4)(5)(10) A "whole person care" approach that coordinates care across physical health, behavioral health, and social service sectors may bridge the gap of physical and mental health.(11)(12)(13)(14) The level that comorbid medical and/or developmental conditions are present may be described on a continuum (none/absent, low, moderate, and severe) and may impact determination of the appropriate level of care for treatment (ie, admission to a higher level of care).(1)(3)(4)(5)(15)
- D. A significant comorbid substance use disorder (either reflecting comorbidity in a patient whose primary diagnosis is a psychiatric disorder, such as an affective disorder, or is present in a patient with a polysubstance use disorder) has the potential to impact the appropriate level of care in which the underlying condition is managed, or require consideration of a program with structures in place to treat multiple conditions, such as a dual-diagnosis program. The risk for problems with substance use is increased with the presence of many types of behavioral disturbance (eg, impulse control disorders, or self-medication of depression or anxiety symptoms). The severity of the substance use disorder as it relates to the underlying psychiatric condition includes the frequency and chronicity of use, ability to control use, intensity of other symptoms (eg, cravings, withdrawal), or other negative impact on the underlying condition.(1)(3)(4)(5)(7)(8)
- E. Evaluation/assessment and treatment of co-occurring substance use disorders through services and treatment settings capable of rendering integrated care is recommended.(1)(2)(3)(4)(5) A "whole person care" approach that coordinates care across physical health, behavioral health, and social service sectors may bridge the gap of physical and mental health.(11)(12)(13)(14) The level that comorbid substance use disorders contribute to the primary presenting condition may be described on a continuum (none/absent, low, moderate, and severe) and may impact determination of the appropriate level of care for treatment (ie, admission to a higher level of care or specialty dual-diagnosis program).(1)(3)(4)(5)(15)
- F. Intake and assessment should include a mental status examination and memory assessment. If cognitive impairments are identified, they may require modifying the intensity or pace of planned interventions to allow the patient to participate in the program, or using an enhanced program designed to address co-occurring cognitive disorders.(8)(16)(17)(18)(19)(20)

Serious dysfunction in daily living for adult

- **Serious** dysfunction in daily living for adult is present, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following(1)(2)(3)(4)(5)(6):
 - Serious deterioration in quality of interpersonal interactions (eg, impulsive or abusive behaviors)
 - Significant withdrawal and avoidance of almost all social interaction
 - Consistent failure to achieve self-care (eg, personal hygiene, appearance) to usual standards
 - Serious disturbance in vegetative status (eg, weight change, sleep disruption) threatening physical function
 - Inability to perform close to usual standards in adult obligations (eg, work, parenting) and neglecting these responsibilities frequently or over extended period of time
 - Other evidence of serious dysfunction

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Serious dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent

- **Serious** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent is present, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following(1)(2)(3)(4)(5)(6)(7):
 - Serious deterioration in interpersonal interactions (eg, impulsive or abusive behaviors)
 - Significant withdrawal and avoidance of almost all social interaction
 - Consistent failure to achieve self-care as appropriate to age or developmental level
 - Serious disturbance in vegetative status (eg, weight change, sleep disruption) threatening physical function
 - Inability to perform adequately in school (including specialized setting) due to disruptive or aggressive behavior
 - Severely diminished ability to assess consequences of own actions (eg, acts of severe property damage)
 - Other evidence of serious dysfunction

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Severe dysfunction in daily living for adult

- **Severe** dysfunction in daily living for adult is present, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following(1)(2)(3)(4)(5)(6):
 - Incapacitation because of grave disability (eg, severe regression with inability to provide for self)
 - Extreme deterioration in social interactions (eg, threatening behaviors with little or no provocation)
 - Complete withdrawal from all social interactions
 - Complete neglect of self-care with associated impairment in physical status
 - Extreme disruption in vegetative function (eg, life-sustaining functions such as eating)
 - Complete inability to maintain any appropriate aspect of personal responsibility in any adult roles (eg, occupational, parental)
 - Other evidence of severe dysfunction

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Severe dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent

- **Severe** dysfunction in daily living for child or adolescent is present, as indicated by **1 or more** of the following(1)(2)(3)(4)(5)(6)(7):
 - Incapacitation because of grave disability (eg, severe regression with inability to provide for self)
 - Extreme deterioration in interactions with peers, adults, or family (eg, assaultive behaviors with no provocation, high levels of family conflict)
 - Complete withdrawal from all social interactions
 - Complete neglect of self-care with associated impairment in physical status
 - Extreme disruption in vegetative function (eg, life-sustaining functions such as eating)
 - Nearly complete inability to maintain any appropriate school behavior or academic achievement
 - Severely diminished ability to assess consequences of own actions (eg, acts of severe property damage)
 - Other evidence of severe dysfunction

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Sufficient relief

- Sufficient relief is that which is adequate to alleviate the immediate impetus for recurrence of suicide attempt or act of harm to self or another.(1)(2)(3)

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Suicide attempt

- A suicide attempt may be identified by an actual, interrupted, or aborted act of self-injurious behavior accompanied by **1 or more** of the following(1)(2)(3):
 - Explicit or implicit evidence that the person believed the act would be lethal (eg, gaining access to gun, carbon monoxide inhalation)
 - Explicit or implicit evidence that the person intended to die (eg, act that was unlikely to be discovered in time for rescue, writing suicide note)

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Thoughts of suicide

- Thoughts of suicide or suicidal ideations are defined as "thoughts of serving as the agent of one's own death," to be distinguished from thoughts of death that do not involve actively bringing death about.(1)(2)

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